FurlPay

GLOBAL PAYMENTS RESEARCH · OCTOBER 2026

# Stablecoins for a global economy

The 2026 Report: market data, 23 market profiles, networks, regulation and outlook.



$300.9B stablecoin supply

$74.6B USDC

117 countries indexed

Data to 2 October 2026 · Evidence-graded · Not investment, legal or tax advice

CONTENTS

# Eighty-seven pages on where stablecoins and digital accounts move money

This edition updates the September 2026 research base with every material development to 2 October 2026, including the Chainalysis 2026 Global Crypto Adoption Index, the Open USD launch, the first binding GENIUS Act rule and Brazil's Resolution 561 entering force. Part IV (pages 50–63) adds Paxos, SEC filings, audits, liquidity, yield rules, cross-chain rails, privacy and depeg risk; Part V (pages 64–74) covers fiat rails, licences, virtual IBANs and Verification of Payee; Part VI (75–83) benchmarks the digital banks that issue IBANs.


**FRONT**

How to read this report 03
Executive dashboard 04
Key findings 05
What changed: 19 Sep – 2 Oct 2026 07
Seven ways to measure volume 08

**PART I · MARKET & ISSUERS**

Total stablecoin supply 10
Issuer landscape 11
Real-economy payments 12
USDC in 2026 13
Circle reserves & metrics 14
Circle financials 15
Tether Q2 2026 16
USDC vs USDT 17
Chains 18
Global payments context 19

**PART II · COUNTRIES**

Chainalysis 2026 index 21
Cross-border boom 22
Regions & USDC strongholds 23
United States 24
India deep dive 25
Brazil 27
Latin America 28
APAC 29
Singapore · Hong Kong · Japan 30
Korea · China · Australia 31
Southeast Asia 32
Africa 33
Middle East & Europe 34
23-market scorecard 35

**PART III · NETWORKS & USE CASES**

Visa 37
Mastercard 38
Open USD (OUSD) 39
Circle infrastructure & Arc 40
Stripe, Tempo & Coinbase 41
Banks & settlement assets 42
Stablecoin cards 43
Cross-border economics 44
Merchant, treasury, remittance 45
AI-agent payments 46
Regulation 47
FurlPay market position 48
Outlook & scenario model 49

**PART IV · STRUCTURE & RISK**

Paxos & GDN 51
PYUSD & USDG 52
SEC filings: issuer economics 53
Audits & attestations 54
Market makers 55
DeFi liquidity & TVL 56
The yield wall 57
Tokenized Treasuries 58
Cross-chain rails 59
Confidential payments 60
Depegs & reserves 61
Cost economics 62
Addendum verification 63

**PART V · FIAT RAILS & LICENCES**

Licensing stack 65
MiCA after transition 66
MiCA review, EUR coins 67
PSD2–MiCA & PSD3 68
Virtual IBANs 69
Verification of Payee 70
Safeguarding 71
Canada 72
Public registers 73
Flow & dossier check 74

**PART VI · DIGITAL BANKS & IBANS**

Verified league table 76
Revolut 77
UK digital banks 78
Wise 79
N26, bunq, Klarna 80
PayPal, Stripe, Banking Circle 81
Local & virtual IBANs 82
Dossier check 83
Sources 84

READ FIRST

# Transaction volume is not payment volume

Stablecoin data is reported across four layers that differ by one to two orders of magnitude. This report keeps them separate on every page and labels each major figure by source type.

## The four layers of stablecoin activity

| LAYER | WHAT IT COUNTS | EXAMPLE FIGURES |
|---|---|---|
| **A · On-chain transfers** | Every token transfer incl. exchange wallet moves, DeFi loops, bots | $33T raw (2025); USDC $14.8T in Q2'26 [41,1] |
| **B · Adjusted transfers** | Layer A minus bots, wash trading, intra-entity transfers | $10.8T (2025); $8.82T H1'26 [9] |
| **C · Settlement** | Obligations between regulated institutions settled in stablecoins | Visa $20B run rate; CPN $14.7B [12,1] |
| **D · Economic payments** | Identified end-user payments: B2B, remittance, payroll, cards | $390B 2025 [8]; ~$400B [16] |




Bar widths are illustrative of scale ordering, not to scale: Layer D is roughly 1% of Layer A.

## Evidence grading

### Source labels

- PRIMARY — Issuer, network, regulator, filing
- SECONDARY — Reputable media reporting a primary figure
- COMPANY CLAIM — Operating metric disclosed only by the company
- INDEPENDENT — Third-party analytics: DeFiLlama, Allium, Artemis, Chainalysis
- ESTIMATE / MODEL — Analyst estimate or this report's scenario model

### Status labels

- VERIFIED — Matches original source and period
- PARTIAL — Source found; definition or period differs
- AMBIGUOUS — Method unclear or competing figures
- OUTDATED — Superseded by newer data
- UNVERIFIED — No original source located

RESEARCH WINDOW

January 2025 – 2 October 2026. Numbers in square brackets map to the source list on pages 84–87. Where only secondary coverage of a primary disclosure was reachable, the figure is attributed to the primary party. Commissioned research (CoinDesk Research APAC, commissioned by Ripple) is flagged.

EXECUTIVE DASHBOARD

# The numbers that matter, and what they measure

STABLECOIN SUPPLY
**$300.9B**
1 Oct 2026, 195 assets, 152 issuers, 47 chains. Peak $322.4B on 17 May 2026 [56,5]
INDEPENDENT

USDC IN CIRCULATION
**$74.6B**
21 Sep 2026, Circle weekly data; reserves $74.8B [54]
PRIMARY

USDT IN CIRCULATION
**$184.6B**
30 Jun 2026 attestation; >60% market share [66]
COMPANY CLAIM

USDC ON-CHAIN VOLUME
**$14.8T**
Q2 2026, one quarter, +151% YoY. Layer A, not payments [1]
PRIMARY

REAL STABLECOIN PAYMENTS
**$390B**
2025, all stablecoins; ~0.02% of global payments [8]
ESTIMATE

CROSS-BORDER STABLECOIN FLOWS
**$220.3B**
Jul 2025–Jun 2026, +77.5% YoY, avg ~$3,000 per transfer [65]
INDEPENDENT

HOLDER ADDRESSES
**308.4M**
1 Oct 2026, up from ~269M mid-2026 [56,5]
INDEPENDENT

VISA SETTLEMENT RUN RATE
**$20B**
Sep 2026, >15x YoY; 160+ stablecoin card programs [12]
COMPANY CLAIM

CRYPTO-CARD SPEND / MONTH
**$759M**
Jul 2026 on-chain observed; USDC funds 58% [32]
INDEPENDENT

APAC SHARE OF PAYMENTS
**51.2%**
Of identified stablecoin payment volume; USDT = 91% of it [7]
SECONDARY

GRASSROOTS ADOPTION
**#1 Brazil**
Chainalysis 2026 index of 117 countries; $252.5B crypto economy [65]
INDEPENDENT

GENIUS ACT EFFECTIVE
**18 Jan 2027**
Latest date; Treasury's first interim final rule 30 Sep 2026 [19,59]
LAW

CIRCLE PAYMENTS NETWORK
**$14.7B**
Annualized, end-Q2 2026; 175 enrolled institutions [1]
COMPANY CLAIM

X402 AGENT VOLUME IN USDC
**99.3%**
Yet one 30-day window = $24.2M total [1,36]
COMPANY CLAIM

OUSD SEED LIQUIDITY
**$1B+**
Launched 30 Sep 2026 by Open Standard; founders Visa, Mastercard, Stripe, Coinbase, Shopify [63]
NEW

READING THE DASHBOARD

On-chain volume ($14.8T, $33T) is mostly trading, treasury and DeFi movement; payment measures are one to two orders of magnitude smaller. Both are real; they answer different questions.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

# Sixteen findings

The thesis under test, “USDC is becoming an important settlement layer for global payments”, is supported in specific, bounded places: card-network settlement, crypto-linked card spend, institutional mint and redeem, and agent micropayments. It is not yet true for mass consumer or emerging-market retail flows.

01 **Supply has plateaued; activity has not.** Total supply sits near $301B (1 Oct), about 7% below the 17 May peak of $322.4B, while USDC on-chain volume rose 151% YoY to $14.8T in Q2 [56,5,1].

02 **Stablecoins were the bear market's anchor.** Chainalysis finds crypto market cap fell ~50%, yet on-chain economic activity slipped only 1.6% to $9.4T; stablecoin balances held at $98–109B [65].

03 **Cross-border usage is the growth engine.** Stablecoins crossing borders rose 77.5% to $220.3B; monthly flows doubled from $11B (Jan 2025) to $24B (Jun 2026) [65].

04 **“Payments” are still ~1% of volume.** McKinsey/Artemis estimate $390B of real payments in 2025, 58% of it B2B ($226B) [8].

05 **APAC leads payments, but it is a USDT market.** 51.2% of identified payment volume; USDT holds 91% of it, down from 98% in Jan 2025 [7].

06 **USDC won Q3 on net growth.** Circle added $915M of supply in Q3 2026, more than any issuer; Tether contracted by $207.7M [56].

07 **Card networks settle in stablecoins in production.** Visa's run rate went $3.5B → $7B → $20B (Nov 2025 → Sep 2026); Mastercard settles in six stablecoins [10,11,12,14].

08 **USDC leads where compliance meets card rails.** USDC funds 58% of on-chain-observed crypto-card spend (USDT 26%) [32].

09 **Incumbents now issue, not just integrate.** Open USD (OUSD) launched 30 Sep with Visa, Mastercard, Stripe, Coinbase and Shopify as founders, sharing reserve income with distributors [63,64].

10 **Circle owns a chain.** Arc public mainnet went live 16 Sep 2026 with 11 institutional validators incl. BlackRock, DTCC, Visa and Mastercard [67].

11 **US rules: statute yes, market structure no.** Treasury issued the first binding GENIUS rule on 30 Sep ($10B state/federal line); the CLARITY Act failed cloture 49–50 on 15 Sep [59,68].

12 **Brazil drew a line on 1 Oct.** Resolution 561 bars eFX providers from settling offshore legs in stablecoins, even as Brazil ranks #1 for adoption [62,65].

13 **India stays closed onshore.** The RBI told Parliament prohibition remains an option; 3.93 crore KYC'd users hold ~₹20,437 crore in crypto [69].

14 **Peer-to-peer went stablecoin.** Domestic P2P value rose 302.9% to $228.7B; it is now 96% stablecoins [65].

15 **Agent payments are live but tiny.** 75.4M x402 transactions worth $24.2M in a 30-day window (~$0.32 each) [36].

16 **The opportunity is in the plumbing.** Settlement, payouts, treasury and card programs, where the stablecoin is invisible to the end user, show the strongest real usage.



VERDICT ON THE CORE THESIS

True for institutional and network settlement; partly true for card-funded consumer spend; not yet true for mass remittances and emerging-market retail, where USDT dominates. On measured payment volume, USDC is an important but minority participant whose regulated position is strengthening.

NETWORK SETTLEMENT

**True**

Visa, Mastercard, CPN, bank mint/redeem

CONSUMER CARDS

**Partly**

58% USDC share of card spend

EM RETAIL & REMITTANCE

**Not yet**

USDT 91% in APAC; 88.7% in Brazil

WHAT CHANGED

# Twelve developments from 15 September to 1 October 2026

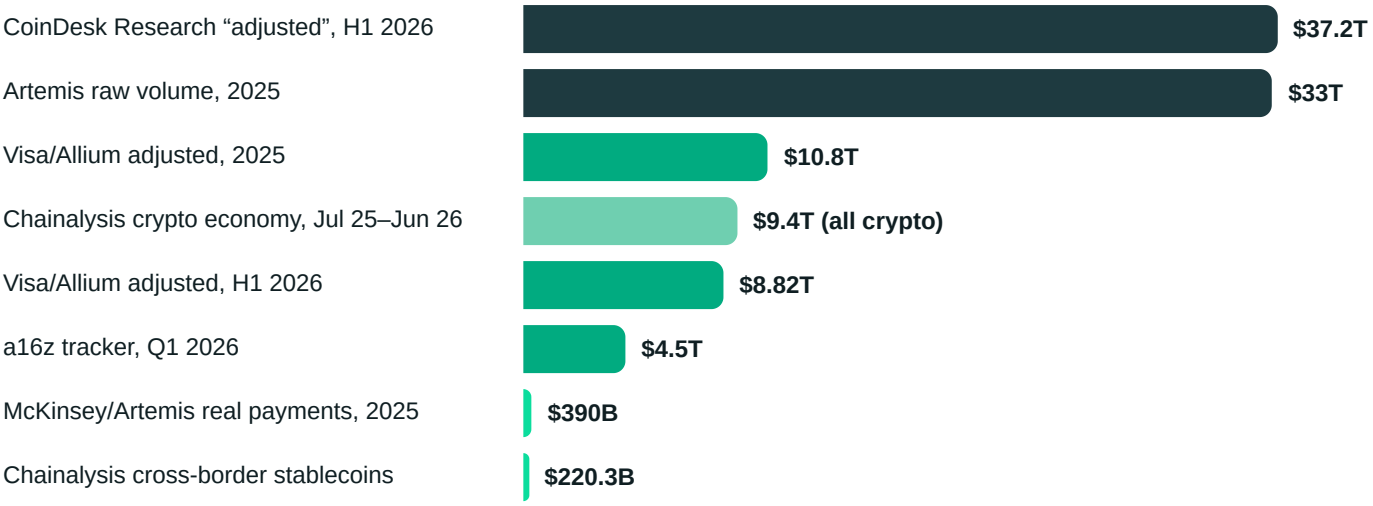
The two weeks before publication were the busiest of the year for stablecoin policy and infrastructure.

| DATE (2026) | DEVELOPMENT | WHY IT MATTERS |
|---|---|---|
| **15 Sep** | CLARITY Act cloture fails 49–50 in the US Senate [68] | Market-structure law unlikely in 2026; GENIUS remains the only statute |
| **16 Sep** | Circle's Arc public mainnet live; 11 founding validators; 10B ARC genesis mint, no public launch committed [67] | USDC-native settlement chain with sub-second finality |
| **21 Sep** | USDC circulation $74.6B (+$0.3B in a week); reserves $74.8B [54] | Supply turned up after summer redemptions |
| **22 Sep** | SoFi to settle card transactions on Mastercard with SoFiUSD, >$25B annual volume expected [64] | Bank-issued stablecoin enters card settlement at scale |
| **23 Sep** | Chainalysis 2026 Adoption Index: Brazil #1, US #2, Nigeria #3, India #6 [65] | New 4-factor methodology; stablecoins drive resilience |
| **23 Sep** | Binance buys $100M of Circle stock and renews USDC distribution deal [73] | Largest exchange aligns with USDC |
| **24 Sep** | Federal Reserve proposes GENIUS prudential and application rules (R-1899, R-1900) [60] | Fed joins OCC in rulemaking; 60-day comments |
| **29 Sep** | Coinbase–Citi fiat-to-stablecoin business payments partnership [73] | Global bank on-ramp for corporate stablecoin flows |
| **30 Sep** | Open USD (OUSD) live on Base, Ethereum, Solana, Tempo [63] | Networks and processors now co-own an issuer |
| **30 Sep** | Treasury interim final rule: $10B state-pathway threshold; larger issuers move federal within 360 days [59] | First binding GENIUS rule |
| **1 Oct** | Brazil Res. 561 in force: no stablecoin settlement for eFX offshore legs [62] | First G20 rollback for regulated cross-border rails |
| **1 Oct** | Total stablecoin supply $300.9B; 308.4M holder addresses [56] | Q3: Circle +$915M, Ripple +$765M, Tether −$208M |

VOLUME, SEVEN WAYS

# The same market, measured from $220B to $37T

Periods and methods differ; bars are not additive. Use the measure that matches the question being asked.




### WHY $37.2T IS NOT PAYMENTS

CoinDesk Research does not disclose its adjustment method; the figure exceeds 2025 raw volume ($33T), so it reads as near-raw. The Visa/Allium method, which strips bots, wash trading and intra-entity transfers, gives $8.82T for the same half-year [7,9].

### WHY $390B IS THE PAYMENTS ANCHOR

McKinsey/Artemis and Stripe's 2025 annual letter (~$400B, ~60% B2B) converge independently on scale and mix. Chainalysis' $220.3B cross-border figure is a conservative lower bound counting only transfers with both ends geolocated [8,16,65].

Sources: Artemis via Forbes; CoinDesk Research (Ripple-commissioned); Visa/Allium via Spark; a16z via Forbes; McKinsey & Artemis; Chainalysis 2026 [41,7,9,40,8,65].

PART I

# Market & issuers




10 Total stablecoin supply

11 Issuer landscape

12 Real-economy payments

13 USDC in 2026

16 Tether Q2 2026

18 Chains

19 Global payments context


**$300.9B**

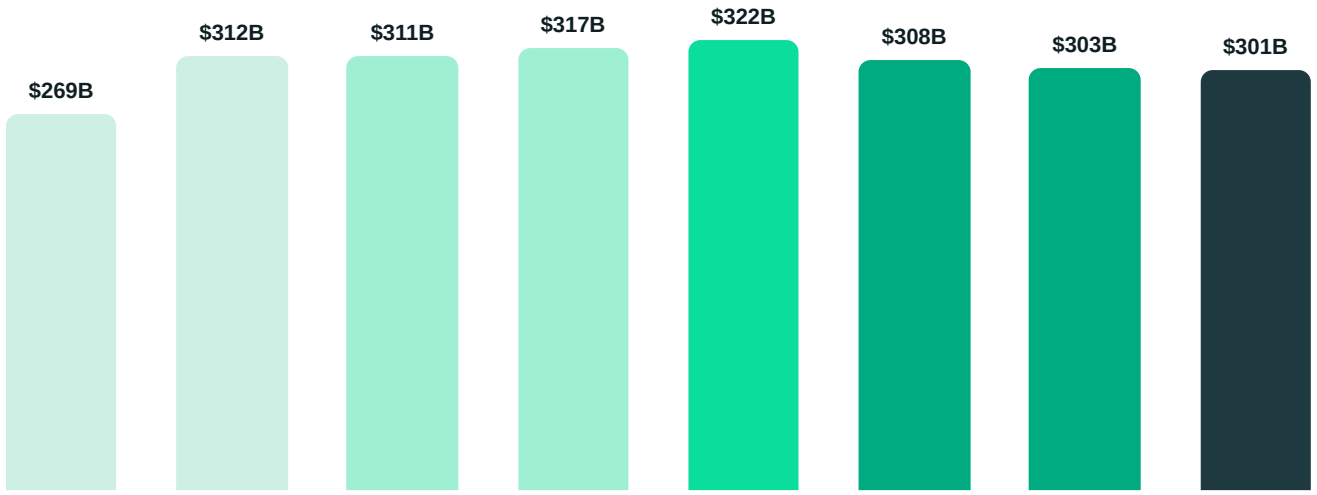
Total stablecoin supply on 1 October 2026 across 195 assets [56]

MARKET · CHAPTER 01

# Total stablecoin supply held near records through a 50% crypto drawdown

## Total stablecoin market capitalization

USD billions; tracker shown per point




YOY SUPPLY GROWTH
**+14.3%**
Aug 2025 → Aug 2026 [5]

USD-PEGGED
**99.4%**
Share of fiat-pegged supply, Sep 2026 [57]

OF CRYPTO MARKET CAP
**~13%**
Stablecoins' share of all crypto value [5]

### DECOUPLED FROM THE CYCLE

Supply fell more than 30% in the last bear market. In 2026 it has held within ~7% of its peak while the crypto market halved. Chainalysis finds stablecoins rose to 22.5% of measured on-chain balances by June 2026, because everything around them lost value [5,65].

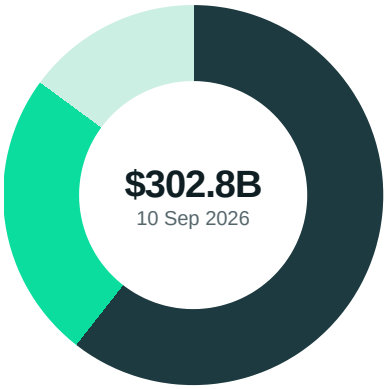
### TRACKER DIFFERENCES

DeFiLlama, Stablecoinbeat and RWA Foundation count different asset sets (e.g. whether yield-bearing tokens are included; Stablecoinbeat excludes $16.2B of them). Compare points from the same tracker for trend; use ranges for level [57,56].

Sources: DeFiLlama via Reap and Decrypt; Federal Reserve FEDS Note (Apr 2026); Stablecoinbeat; RWA Foundation via U.Today [5,6,57,56].

CHAPTER 01 · CONTINUED

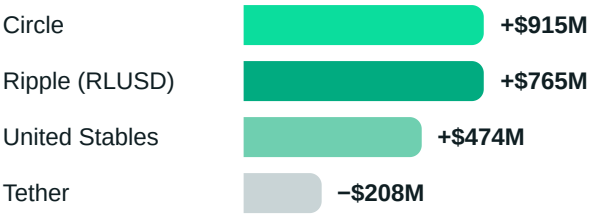
# Two issuers hold ~85% of supply; Q3 growth went to the regulated challengers




- **USDT** $183.4B · 60.6%
- **USDC** $74.2B · 24.5%
- **All others** ~$45B · 14.9%

### Q3 2026 supply change by issuer

1 Jul – 1 Oct




## Selected dollar stablecoins

| STABLECOIN | ISSUER | SUPPLY | DATE | POSITIONING |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **USDT** | Tether | $184.6B | 30 Jun 2026 | Offshore liquidity; emerging-market retail; Tron-heavy [66] |
| **USDC** | Circle | $74.6B | 21 Sep 2026 | Regulated; OCC trust charter; card & bank rails [54,1] |
| **USDG** | Paxos / Global Dollar Network | ~$3.18B | 3 Sep 2026 | 150+ partners share reserve economics; MAS & MiCA [77] |
| **RLUSD** | Ripple | $2.37B → +$765M Q3 | 2026 | Corpay APAC funding; DBS collateral [7,56] |
| **PYUSD** | Paxos for PayPal | ~$2.78B | 19 Aug 2026 | Peak $4.2B (Mar 2026); 70 countries; Mastercard set [81,14] |
| **SoFiUSD** | SoFi Bank | n/d | — | Mastercard card settlement, >$25B/yr expected [64] |
| **OUSD** | Open Standard | New | 30 Sep 2026 | Visa/Mastercard/Stripe/Coinbase/Shopify; $1B+ seed [63] |

**DISTRIBUTION IS THE NEW BATTLEGROUND**

USDG and OUSD pass reserve income to the businesses that distribute them, challenging the issuer-keeps-the-float model. USDC pays partners too: about 56% of USDC reserve income is shared with Coinbase, and Circle renewed a fee deal with Binance in September [71,73,64].

Sources: Stablecoinbeat (10 Sep); RWA Foundation via U.Today; Tether attestation; Circle; CoinGecko via Blockhead [57,56,66,54,63].

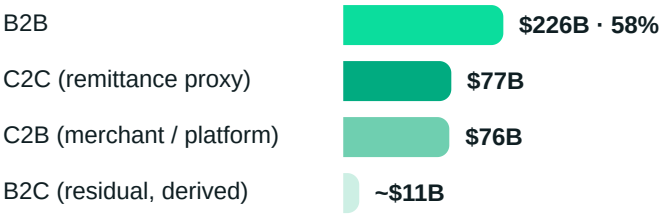
CHAPTER 01 · CONTINUED

# Real-economy payments: $390B, led by business

Payments are identified end-user transfers (Layer D). They are about 1% of stablecoin transaction volume and roughly 0.02% of the >$2 quadrillion global payments market.

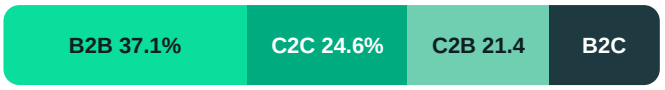
## 2025 payments by segment

McKinsey & Artemis, $B




## H1 2026 share of payment volume

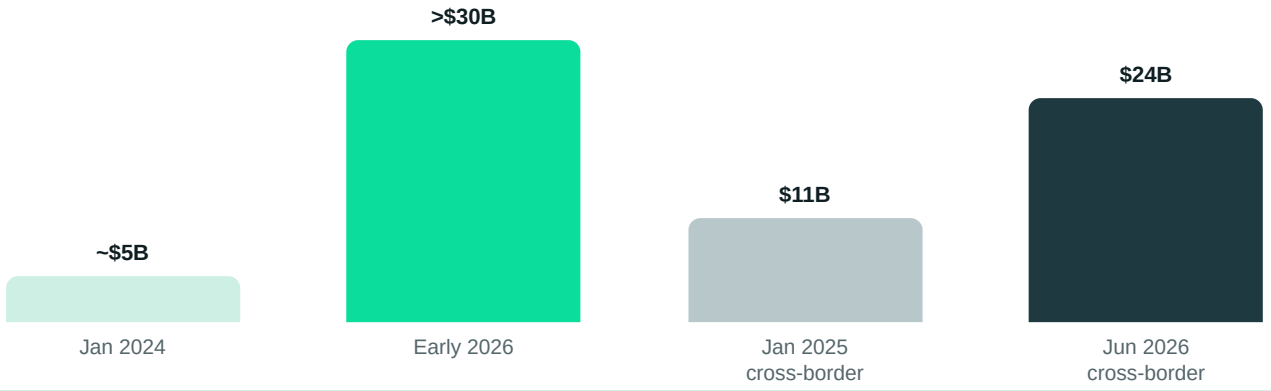
Allium




Methods differ: Allium labels wallet-level flows; McKinsey/Artemis combine labelling and company disclosure.

## Monthly stablecoin payment volume

USD billions




Left pair: all identified payments (McKinsey/Artemis via BVNK). Right pair: Chainalysis' conservative cross-border measure. Different scopes, same direction: roughly a doubling.

FIRMS ALREADY USING
**13%**
EY-Parthenon survey of 350 firms [53]

REPORT ≥10% SAVINGS
**41%**
Mostly on cross-border payments [53]

OF GLOBAL PAYMENTS
**~0.02%**
Stablecoins vs. >$2 quadrillion [8]

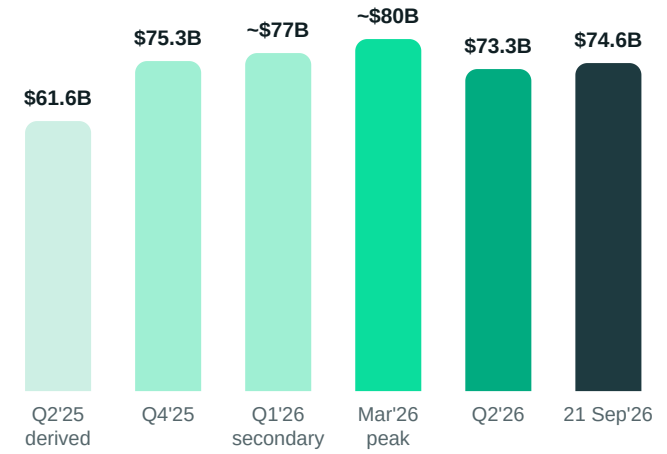
Sources: McKinsey & Artemis (Feb 2026); Allium via CoinDesk Research; Stripe 2025 letter; Chainalysis 2026; EY-Parthenon via Tazapay [8,7,16,65,53].

ISSUER · CHAPTER 02

# USDC in 2026: flat float, rising velocity

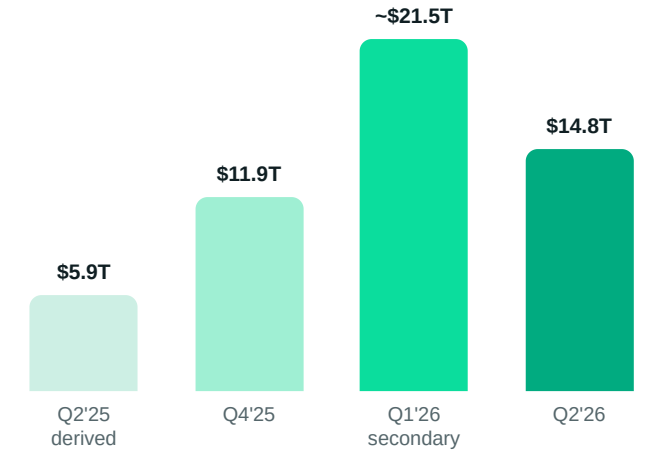
## USDC in circulation

USD billions




## USDC on-chain volume per quarter

USD trillions




**Q2 VOLUME YOY**
**+151%**
On-chain, Layer A [1]

**NATIVE CHAINS**
**38**
16 Sep 2026, incl. Arc [4]

**WALLET REACH**
**500M+**
End-user wallet products with USDC access [4]

**MINT COUNTRIES**
**185+**
Wires and bank transfers via Circle Mint [4]

**INTERPRETATION**

Redemptions exceeded mints in Q2 ($87B vs $83B), yet on-chain volume more than doubled. More work is done per dollar of float. Circle's 40% through-cycle circulation CAGR target has not been met over the last four quarters [1].

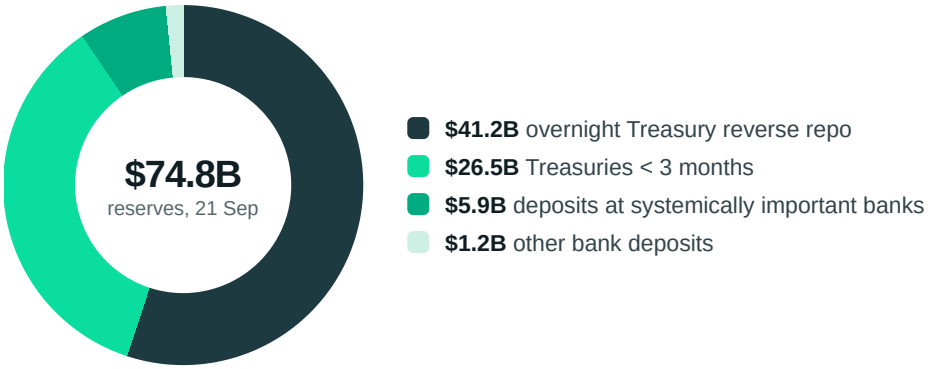
**SEPTEMBER TURN**

In the week to 21 Sep, Circle minted ~$10.1B and redeemed ~$9.8B, lifting supply to $74.6B. Q3 net supply growth of $915M was the largest of any issuer [54,56].

Sources: Circle Q2'26 results; Circle Q4'25 via PYMNTS; Q1'26 via web3wagmi (secondary); Circle USDC page; PANews [1,71,72,4,54]. Q2'25 derived from reported YoY growth.

CHAPTER 02 · CONTINUED

# What backs a USDC, and how Circle's business is running




## Circle operating metrics, Q2 2026

| METRIC | VALUE | YOY | LABEL |
|---|---|---|---|
| **USDC in circulation, period end / average** | $73.3B / $76.5B | +19% / +25% | PRIMARY |
| **USDC minted / redeemed in quarter** | $83B / $87B | +97% / +113% | PRIMARY |
| **USDC on Circle platform, period end** | $12.4B | +106% | PRIMARY |
| **Meaningful wallets (>$10 USDC)** | 7.0M | +24% | PRIMARY |
| **Circle Payments Network, annualized (T30D)** | $14.7B | +76% QoQ | COMPANY CLAIM |
| **CPN enrolled financial institutions** | 175 | +29% QoQ | COMPANY CLAIM |
| **Reserve return rate** | 3.5% | −66 bps | PRIMARY |

**CONCENTRATION RISK**

Coinbase held an average $19B of USDC in Q1 2026, more than a quarter of supply. Tokenized money-market funds that pay yield are flagged by Circle as competition for USDC balances [35,1].

Sources: PANews / TokenPost weekly Circle data (25 Sep 2026); Circle Q2 2026 results [54,1,35].

CHAPTER 02 · CONTINUED

# Circle's economics: rate-sensitive income, expanding distribution

**REVENUE & RESERVE INCOME**
**$701M**
Q2 2026, +7% YoY [1]

**RESERVE INCOME**
**$668M**
+5% YoY [1]

**ADJUSTED EBITDA**
**$143M**
+8% YoY [1]

**RESERVE INCOME TO COINBASE**
**~56%**
Revenue-share agreement [71]

## 2026 institutional distribution (Circle-reported and press)

| PARTNER | DEVELOPMENT | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **BNY** | Primary reserve custodian; USDC mint/redeem in Digital Asset Custody | LIVE |
| **Standard Chartered** | Bank-led USDC mint/redeem for institutions; Arc validator | LIVE |
| **Binance** | $100M Circle share purchase; USDC distribution deal renewed (23 Sep) | NEW |
| **Nium** | USDC settlement via CPN into 190+ payout countries | LIVE |
| **JCB (Japan)** | Cross-border treasury in USDC; in-store payments for visitors | PROPOSED |
| **Kakao (Korea)** | Exploratory collaboration | PROPOSED |
| **Grupo Bind (Argentina)** | USDC/ARS institutional liquidity | LIVE |
| **Marex** | First USDC initial margin for CFTC-regulated derivatives | LIVE |
| **Intuit** | Multi-year partnership to embed USDC (announced with Q4'25) | PROPOSED |
| **OCC** | Final approval for Circle national trust bank | LIVE |

**RATE EXPOSURE**
A 66 bp fall in the reserve return rate offset most of the 25% growth in average USDC. Lower US rates compress issuer income unless circulation grows faster [1].

**AGENT STACK & ARC**
Circle launched Agent Stack (900+ paid services) in May and Arc mainnet in September, adding product and network revenue lines beyond float income [1,67].

Sources: Circle Q2'26 results and earnings call; PYMNTS; Blockhead [1,2,71,73].

CHAPTER 02 · TETHER

# Tether Q2 2026: record operating profit, halved buffer

**USDT SUPPLY**
**$184.6B**
30 Jun, +$446M in Q2 [66]

**NET OPERATING PROFIT**
**$1.5B**
Q2; up from ~$1.04B in Q1 [66]

**EXCESS RESERVES**
**$4.11B**
Down from $8.23B in Q1 [66]

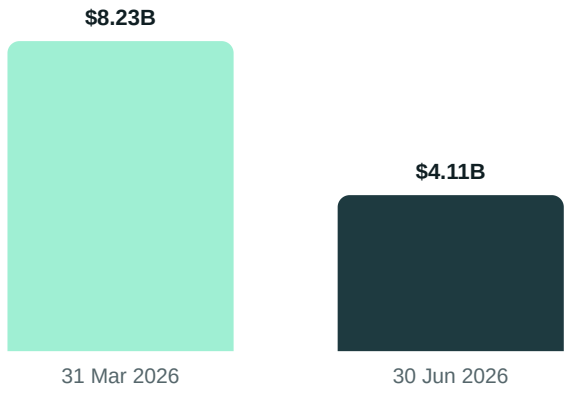
**RECORD USDT SUPPLY**
**$189.8B**
May 2026 [66]

## Balance sheet, 30 June 2026

| ITEM | VALUE |
|---|---|
| **Total assets** | $187.75B |
| **Total liabilities** | $183.64B |
| **Gold** | ~146.2 t · $18.84B |
| **Bitcoin** | 98,932 BTC · ~$5.8B |
| **Secured loans** | $2.38B (−$2.4B) |
| **Attestor** | BDO; KPMG audit engaged Mar 2026, not completed |

## Excess reserve buffer

USD billions




**WHY PROFIT ROSE WHILE THE CUSHION FELL**

Operating profit excludes mark-to-market moves. Declines in gold and bitcoin holdings, plus capital deployment, more than absorbed the quarter's $1.5B; one analysis puts the first-half comprehensive result near −$3.17B [66].

**MARKET POSITION**

USDT held >60% of supply through 2026 and ~91% of identified APAC payment volume; most new cross-border corridors tracked by Chainalysis ran on USDT [66,7,65].

**US EXPOSURE**

Tether describes itself as one of the largest holders of US Treasuries, ranking USDT as the 19th-largest holder if it were a country [66].

Sources: Tether Q2 2026 attestation via Cointelegraph, crypto.news, Stablecoin Insider, Bitcoin.com, FRNT [66]. Figures are company-reported, attested not audited.

COMPARISON

# USDC vs USDT: different strengths, different markets

No overall ranking is implied. USDT leads supply and emerging-market retail; USDC leads filtered volume, card spend and regulated institutional channels.

| DIMENSION | USDC | USDT |
|---|---|---|
| **Circulation** | $74.6B (21 Sep 2026) [54] | $184.6B (30 Jun 2026) [66] |
| **Supply share** | ~24.5% [57] | ~60.6% [57] |
| **Q3 2026 net change** | +$915M [56] | −$207.7M [56] |
| **Transaction volume, 2025** | $18.3T [5] | $13.3T [5] |
| **Adjusted volume share, Jun 2026** | ~67% [9] | ~32% [9] |
| **APAC payment share, Jul 2026** | Within 9% “others” [7] | 91% [7] |
| **Crypto-card spend share, Jul 2026** | 58% [32] | 26% [32] |
| **Brazil declared volume, 2019–25** | 7.1% [27] | 88.7% [27] |
| **Main chains** | Ethereum, Solana, Base; 38 native [4] | Tron ($87.9B), Ethereum ($78.7B) [58] |
| **Reserve reporting** | Weekly data; monthly third-party assurance [4] | Quarterly BDO attestation [66] |
| **Regulatory positioning** | MiCA-compliant; OCC trust charter; bank mint/redeem [1] | Dominant offshore liquidity; exchange-led |
| **Network settlement** | Visa, Mastercard [10,14] | Not in Mastercard's June 2026 set [14] |

## Card spend share




## APAC payment share



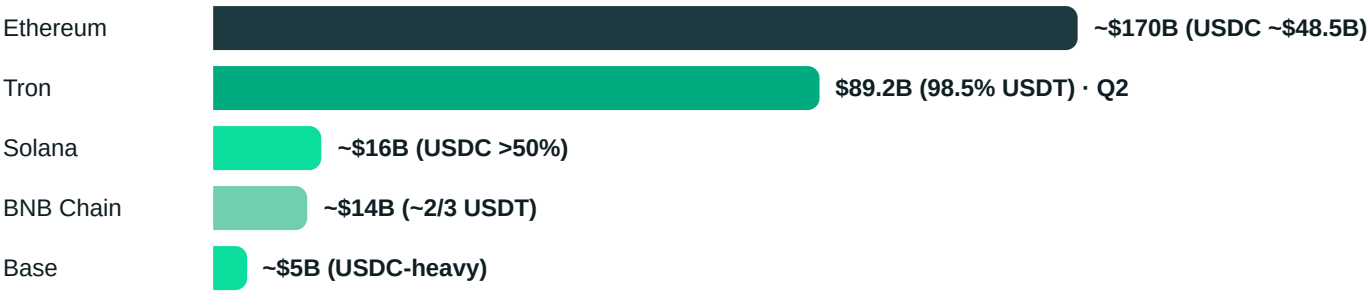

Sources: As cited per row.

CHAINS

# Where stablecoins live vs. where payments happen

## Stablecoin supply by chain

approx., USD billions, 2026




| CHAIN | PAYMENT RELEVANCE (DOCUMENTED) |
|---|---|
| **Tron** | Record $2.1T USDT transfers in Q2 2026; network fees $699.4M; emerging-market P2P and remittance [58] |
| **Ethereum** | Settlement and institutional activity; $78.7B USDT at Q2 end [58,51] |
| **Solana** | Visa US USDC settlement; 19% of crypto-card spend [10,32] |
| **Base** | x402 agent payments; 19% of card spend [35,32] |
| **Optimism** | 29% of crypto-card spend [32] |
| **Polygon** | >$2B app payments in Jan 2026 (Revolut, Tazapay, Avenia) [41] |
| **Arc (Circle)** | Mainnet 16 Sep 2026; USDC gas; finality <1s; benchmark >3,000 TPS [67] |
| **Tempo (Stripe/Paradigm)** | Mainnet Mar 2026; OUSD native at launch [17,63] |

**ISSUANCE SHARE ≠ PAYMENT SHARE**

Ethereum holds the most supply, but card spend concentrates on Optimism, Solana and Base, and grassroots remittances on Tron. New payment-purpose L1s (Arc, Tempo) run permissioned institutional validator sets.

Sources: DeFiLlama via Bitcoin Foundation News (Apr 2026); Messari State of TRON Q2 2026; a16z; Arc [51,58,32,67].

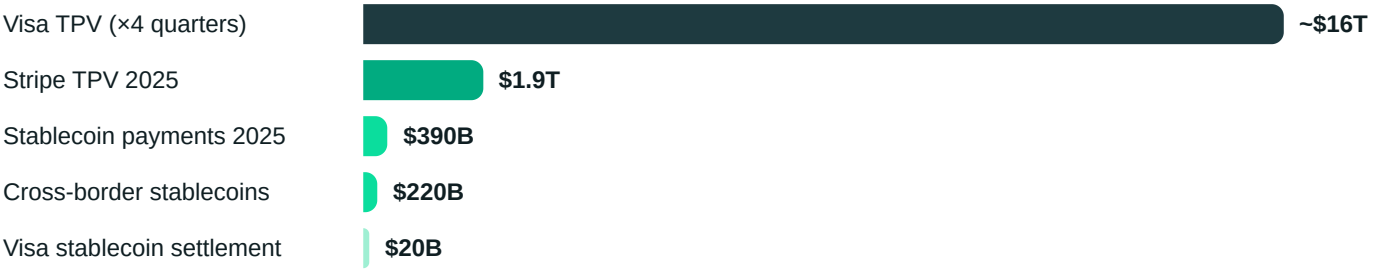
CONTEXT · CHAPTER 03

# A rounding error against incumbent rails, which is why incumbents integrate

| BENCHMARK | FIGURE | SOURCE |
|---|---|---|
| **Global payments volume** | >$2 quadrillion / yr | McKinsey [8] |
| **Visa total payment volume, FQ3 2026 (one quarter)** | >$4T | Visa [13] |
| **Visa processed transactions, quarter** | 71.7B | 24/7 Wall St [74] |
| **Stripe total payment volume, 2025** | $1.9T (+34%) | Stripe [16] |
| **Brazil Pix transactions, 2025** | 80B (+25%) | BCB [30] |
| **Chainalysis on-chain crypto economy, Jul 25–Jun 26** | $9.4T | Chainalysis [65] |
| **Stablecoin real-economy payments, 2025** | $390B | McKinsey & Artemis [8] |
| **Cross-border stablecoin flows, Jul 25–Jun 26** | $220.3B | Chainalysis [65] |
| **Visa stablecoin settlement run rate, Sep 2026** | $20B | Visa [12] |

## Annualized scale, log-like view

USD




**STRATEGIC LOGIC FOR NETWORKS**

Visa's CEO frames stablecoins as optionality against roughly $4T of quarterly volume, and Visa books no separate stablecoin revenue line. The attraction is 24/7 treasury efficiency and defending distribution, not near-term revenue [13,74].

Sources: As cited per row.

PART II

# Countries & regions




21 Chainalysis 2026 adoption index

22 The cross-border boom

24 United States

25 India deep dive

27 Brazil & Latin America

29 APAC & Southeast Asia

33 Africa, Middle East, Europe


**117**

Countries ranked in the Chainalysis 2026 Global Crypto Adoption Index [65]

GEOGRAPHY · CHAPTER 04

# Chainalysis 2026: Brazil, the US and Nigeria lead grassroots adoption

A new four-factor method (service flows, domestic P2P, cross-border flows and on-chain balances, each PPP-weighted, combined by geometric mean) ranks 117 countries for July 2025 – June 2026.

| # | COUNTRY | FLOWS | BALANCES | P2P | X-BORDER |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Brazil | 3 | 4 | 3 | 2 |
| 2 | United States | 1 | 1 | 20 | 11 |
| 3 | Nigeria | 18 | 18 | 1 | 1 |
| 4 | Japan | 4 | 7 | 10 | 4 |
| 5 | South Korea | 5 | 2 | 12 | 12 |
| 6 | India | 2 | 3 | 16 | 16 |
| 7 | Ukraine | 8 | 8 | 6 | 6 |
| 8 | Thailand | 25 | 6 | 5 | 8 |
| 9 | South Africa | 33 | 16 | 4 | 3 |
| 10 | Canada | 15 | 9 | 7 | 7 |

| # | COUNTRY | FLOWS | BALANCES | P2P | X-BORDER |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 11 | Mexico | 21 | 13 | 8 | 5 |
| 12 | China | 29 | 15 | 2 | 14 |
| 13 | Germany | 12 | 5 | 15 | 15 |
| 14 | Indonesia | 11 | 12 | 13 | 10 |
| 15 | Australia | 24 | 10 | 11 | 9 |
| 16 | Russia | 9 | 21 | 9 | 19 |
| 17 | United Kingdom | 6 | 11 | 24 | 24 |
| 18 | Vietnam | 7 | 23 | 14 | 17 |
| 19 | Philippines | 14 | 14 | 22 | 21 |
| 20 | Türkiye | 16 | 19 | 17 | 20 |

BRAZIL CRYPTO ECONOMY

**$252.5B**

Top-4 on every factor, #1 on none

NIGERIA P2P · X-BORDER

**#1 · #1**

Strongest grassroots flow profile

INDIA

**#2 flows**

Second-largest service flows; #6 overall

HOW TO USE THIS TABLE

Sub-ranks show what drives each market: the US and India are service-flow and balance markets; Nigeria, South Africa and China are P2P and cross-border markets; Brazil is balanced across all four. The index measures crypto use broadly, not USDC specifically.

Sources: Chainalysis, 2026 Global Crypto Adoption Index, 23 Sep 2026 [65].

CHAPTER 04 · CONTINUED

# The payments half of crypto kept growing while prices halved

**CRYPTO ECONOMY**
**$9.4T**
−1.6% vs $9.5T prior period

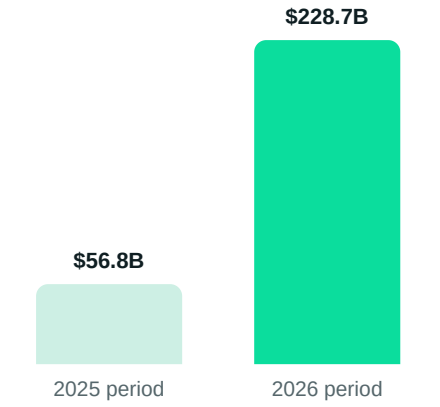
**CROSS-BORDER STABLECOINS**
**+77.5%**
$124.2B → $220.3B

**AVG CROSS-BORDER TRANSFER**
**~$3,000**
Too small to be institutional

**P2P IN STABLECOINS**
**96%**
Of domestic wallet-to-wallet value

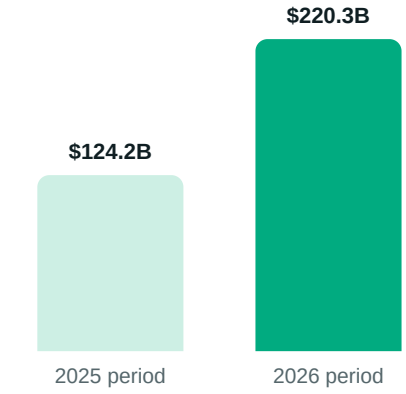
### Domestic P2P value

USD billions



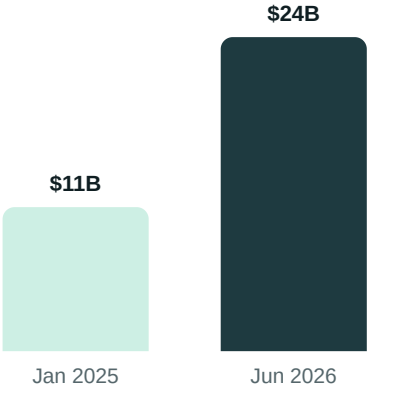

### Cross-border stablecoins

USD billions




### Monthly cross-border

USD billions



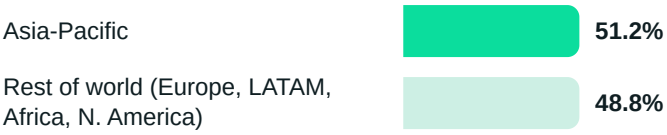

| SIGNAL | VALUE | READ-ACROSS |
|---|---|---|
| **Service inflows (exchanges, DeFi)** | $9.30T → $8.90T (−4.3%) | Price-sensitive trading fell |
| **Stablecoin service inflows** | +5.3% | Stablecoin on-ramps grew anyway |
| **Transfers <$100 / $100–1,000** | +78.4% / +58.6% | Retail persisted through the bear market |
| **Long-tail corridors (bottom 3 quartiles)** | $0.26B → $8.66B | Stablecoins opening quiet corridors |
| **New corridors tracked** | 4,708 carrying $2.64B | Mostly USDT |
| **Stablecoin share of on-chain balances** | 22.5% (Jun 2026) | Balances held $98–109B; other assets −55.6% |

Sources: Chainalysis 2026 Geography of Crypto (Jul 2025–Jun 2026 period). Cross-border figures count only transfers with both ends geolocated, a lower bound [65].

REGIONS · CHAPTER 05

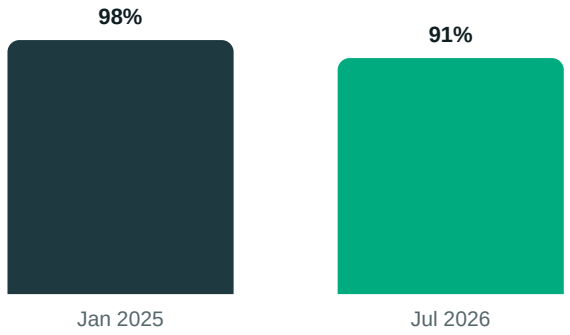
# Stablecoin demand is not the same as USDC demand

### Share of identified payment volume




CoinDesk Research / Allium; regional split beyond APAC not disclosed in the same dataset. Commissioned by Ripple.

### USDT share of APAC payments




### Where USDC evidence is strongest

| STRONGHOLD | EVIDENCE |
|---|---|
| **Card-linked spending** | 58% of on-chain-observed crypto-card spend, Jul 2026 [32] |
| **Card-network settlement** | Visa US launch settled in USDC on Solana; Mastercard lists USDC first [10,14] |
| **Filtered (adjusted) volume** | ~67–70% of Visa/Allium adjusted volume, Jun 2026 [9,2] |
| **Bank-distributed institutional access** | BNY, Standard Chartered mint/redeem; Grupo Bind (Argentina) [1] |
| **Exchange distribution** | Coinbase (~$19B avg, Q1); Binance deal renewed Sep 2026 [35,73] |
| **Agent payments** | 99.3% of x402 agent-payment volume [1] |
| **Regulated jurisdictions** | MiCA-compliant (EU); ADGM permission (UAE); SBI VC Trade (Japan) [38] |

USDT · APAC PAYMENTS
**91%**
Jul 2026 [7]

USDT · BRAZIL DECLARED
**88.7%**
2019–25; USDC 7.1% [27]

USDC · CARD SPEND
**58%**
Jul 2026 [32]

**NO COUNTRY-LEVEL USDC PAYMENT DATA EXISTS**

No issuer, regulator or analytics provider publishes USDC payment volume by country. Wallet geolocation is probabilistic and exchange flows are off-chain. Country profiles that follow summarise documented evidence only.

COUNTRY · MARKET FOCUS

# United States: the rulebook arrives, market structure stalls

**CHAINALYSIS RANK**
**#2**
#1 in flows and balances [65]

**USDC ON COINBASE**
**$19B+**
Avg Q1 2026 [35]

**STATE-PATHWAY CAP**
**$10B**
Treasury IFR, 30 Sep [59]

**MAX REDEMPTION TIME**
**2 days**
OCC proposal [61]

| DEVELOPMENT | STATUS | DATE |
|---|---|---|
| **GENIUS Act signed into law** | LAW | 18 Jul 2025 |
| **OCC proposed rule: reserves, 2-day redemption, capital, foreign issuers; 0.5% of reserves (≤$500M) in insured deposits above $25B [61]** | PROPOSED | Feb–Mar 2026 |
| **Statutory rulemaking deadline missed by agencies [59]** | Missed | 18 Jul 2026 |
| **Treasury proposal on “offering or selling” stablecoins (comments to 19 Oct) [19]** | PROPOSED | 18 Aug 2026 |
| **CLARITY Act cloture fails 49–50 [68]** | Stalled | 15 Sep 2026 |
| **Fed proposals R-1899 (prudential), R-1900 (applications) [60]** | PROPOSED | 24 Sep 2026 |
| **Treasury interim final rule: ≤$10B issuers may use state regimes; larger move federal within 360 days [59]** | LAW | 30 Sep 2026 |
| **OCC final rule targeted [20]** | Expected | Nov 2026 |
| **GENIUS Act effective (latest date) [19]** | Scheduled | 18 Jan 2027 |

### Production payments

Visa USDC settlement with Cross River and Lead Bank (Dec 2025); Mastercard six-stablecoin settlement (Jun 2026); Stripe USDC acceptance; Marex USDC margin; Coinbase–Citi business payments (29 Sep 2026) [10,14,1,73].

### What it means

Issuers above $10B (USDC, USDT's US arm, OUSD at scale) face a federal regime. Domestic consumer payment use stays limited given mature card, ACH, RTP and FedNow rails; the US story is distribution and settlement.

Sources: OCC, Treasury, Federal Reserve, Sullivan & Cromwell, CNBC, Yahoo Finance [18,19,20,59,60,61,68].

DEEP DIVE · MARKET FOCUS · INDIA I

# India: world-class rails, a closed onshore door

India combines UPI, large export-services receivables and heavy retail crypto use with the most restrictive stance among major economies. The practical USDC↔INR model in 2026 keeps the stablecoin leg offshore.

**CHAINALYSIS 2026**
**#6**
#2 service flows; #3 balances [65]

**KYC'D CRYPTO USERS**
**3.93 cr**
RBI submission to Parliament [69]

**CRYPTO HELD**
**₹20,437 cr**
~$2.3B; 54 FIU-registered VASPs [69]

**USDT PREMIUM**
**7–10%**
Indian exchanges, Jun 2026 [26]

## Regulatory position (not legal advice)

| AREA | STATUS, OCTOBER 2026 |
|---|---|
| **RBI stance** | Policy "leaning towards prohibition"; wants banks insulated from crypto and private stablecoins; prohibition kept as a recognised option before the parliamentary panel [23,69] |
| **Financial Stability Report** | 30 Jun 2026: foreign-currency stablecoins could undermine monetary sovereignty and policy transmission [69] |
| **Policy paper** | Crypto discussion paper shelved again (Apr 2026); no stablecoin framework imminent [25] |
| **Tax** | 30% tax on VDA gains, 1% TDS; VDA definition widened 1 Apr 2026; reporting penalties ₹200/day late, ₹50,000 incorrect [25] |
| **AML** | VDA providers under PMLA with FIU-IND registration (54 registered) [23,69] |
| **FEMA / exports** | A stablecoin received directly is a VDA, not documented export proceeds [24] |
| **Payment aggregators** | RBI PA-Cross Border authorization governs licensed collection (e.g. Xflow) [24] |
| **Government view** | Economic Survey 2025–26 signalled interest in a stablecoin framework, diverging from RBI caution [76] |

**BOTTOM LINE**

No Indian bank, NPCI or RBI-licensed entity was found offering direct USDC settlement as of 2 October 2026. Demand is real; regulated access runs through offshore legs settling in INR.

MARKET FOCUS · INDIA II

# Where India's stablecoin demand shows up

## Use cases: onshore vs offshore-leg model

| USE CASE | ONSHORE USDC TODAY | OFFSHORE-LEG MODEL | KEY DEPENDENCY |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Exporters / SaaS receivables** | Tax & FEMA friction | Live (pilots) | PA-CB partner, e-FIRA |
| **Freelancer income** | VDA tax on conversion | Emerging | Purpose codes, KYC |
| **Inbound remittances** | Not a payment instrument | Limited | RBI policy change |
| **Merchant / UPI acceptance** | Not permitted | No | Regulatory framework |
| **Outbound travel spend (cards)** | Restricted | Via foreign issuers | LRS, issuer policy |

## Documented market signals

### Offshore-leg pilot

Xflow announced a stablecoin payments pilot on 14 May 2026: the stablecoin leg stays outside India and INR settles to the exporter's bank account with an e-FIRA [24].

### Dollar demand

After an Enforcement Directorate action in June 2026, USDT traded at a 7–10% premium on Indian exchanges [26].

### Retail usage

~39M crypto investors holding ~$2.1B (May 2026); stablecoins were 38.5% of WazirX H1 2026 volume [52].

### Cost friction

India was the exception to low APAC stablecoin delivery costs (median 6.1 bps region-wide), due to tax and rail factors [7].

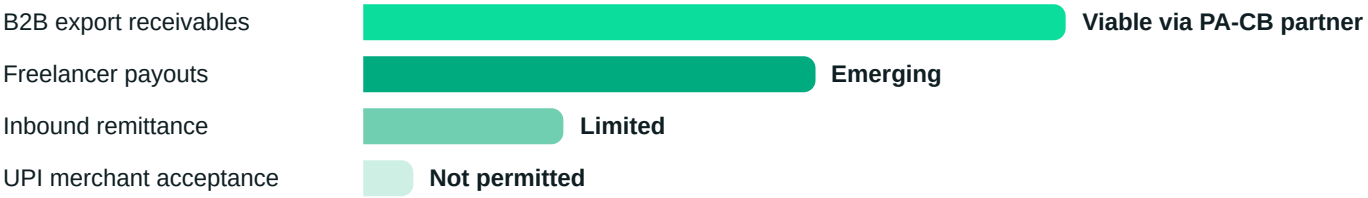
### Resilience

TRM: India was the most resilient major market in Q1 2026, down 6% YoY vs a 20% global average, sustained by P2P [75].

### Measurement caveat

Chainalysis' wealth adjustment shrinks India's allocated exchange value: identical 8.1% traffic shares became 3.2% (India) vs 11.6% (Korea) [65].

## India readiness by FurlPay module (framework)




Qualitative readiness scores by FurlPay Research based on the regulatory evidence above; not a forecast.

COUNTRY · MARKET FOCUS

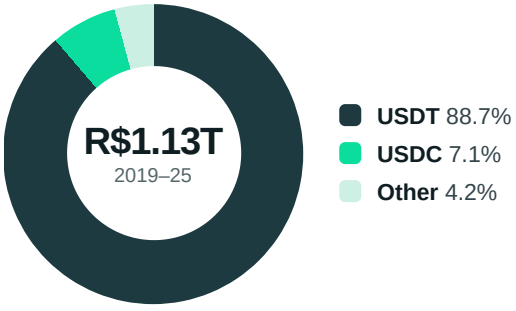
# Brazil: #1 for adoption, first G20 market to close a stablecoin rail

**CHAINALYSIS 2026**
**#1**
$252.5B crypto economy [65]

**DECLARED STABLECOIN OPS**
**R$1.13T**
Aug 2019–Dec 2025, cumulative [27]

**ACTIVE PIX USERS**
**142M**
Apr 2026; 80B txns in 2025 [30]

**RES. 561 IN FORCE**
**1 Oct 2026**
eFX settlement ban [62]




## 2026 regulatory timeline

| DATE | EVENT |
|---|---|
| **2 Feb** | Res. 519–521 in force; VASP authorisation regime |
| **30 Apr** | Res. 561 published |
| **May** | FX reporting for stablecoin operations |
| **1 Oct** | Res. 561 effective |
| **30 Oct** | eFX Unicad registration update; VASP transition ends |

**WHAT RESOLUTION 561 DOES**

From 1 October 2026, the settlement leg between a regulated eFX provider and its overseas counterparty must run through a licensed FX transaction or a non-resident real account. Stablecoins and other virtual assets are barred for that leg. It is not a crypto ban: individual international transfers via authorised VASPs remain permitted, and eFX is restricted to BCB-authorised institutions [62,28].

### Who is affected

Fintechs and eFX firms that settled offshore balances in USDT/USDC. One estimate puts ~90% of Brazil's $6–8B monthly international crypto flow through stablecoins (secondary) [62].

### Expected effects

Higher costs (IOF, correspondent fees) for eFX flows; a two-tier system where licensed banks and VASPs keep stablecoin access; risk that volume shifts to P2P channels with less visibility.

Sources: Chainalysis; Receita Federal via InvestNews; BCB via Mobile Time; CoinDesk; Crumpton Global; CryptoSlate [65,27,30,62,28].

REGION · CHAPTER 06

# Latin America: the most retail-driven stablecoin region

Chainalysis finds Latin America's crypto economy grew 9.8% period-over-period, bucking the global trend, on a collective pivot to stablecoins as a hedge against currency volatility.

### Mexico #11

| | |
|---|---|
| MARKET | US–Mexico among the largest remittance corridors (background); #5 in cross-border flows [65] |
| PAYMENTS | ARQ (ex-DolarApp) early Mastercard stablecoin-settlement participant [14] |
| RAILS | SPEI, CoDi/DiMo |
| RULES | Fintech Law restricts FIs' crypto activity; peso-stablecoin sandbox in process (background) |

### Argentina

| | |
|---|---|
| MARKET | Dollarization demand; savings and P2P use |
| PAYMENTS | Grupo Bind–Circle USDC/ARS institutional liquidity [1]; card spend |
| RAILS | Transferencias 3.0, QR interoperability |
| RULES | CNV VASP (PSAV) registry (background) |

### Venezuela TRM #17

| | |
|---|---|
| MARKET | $17.9B; adoption driven by stablecoins rather than speculation [75] |
| PAYMENTS | Retail savings and transfers under economic stress |
| RAILS | Constrained domestic banking |
| RULES | Sanctions exposure; limited formal framework |

## Regional evidence

| SIGNAL | EVIDENCE |
|---|---|
| **Card spend** | Rain: LATAM one of the clearest stablecoin-card markets; retail card spend +105–106% YoY [34] |
| **Network settlement** | Mastercard stablecoin settlement launched US & LATAM first (Jun 2026) [14] |
| **Visa** | Global stablecoin settlement program spans LAC, Europe, AP, CEMEA [12] |
| **Brazil growth** | Brazil stablecoin activity +495% vs LATAM average +89.4% (secondary) [62] |
| **Colombia, Chile** | In scope; no 2026 primary data specific to USDC payments located |

**IMPLICATION**

LATAM pairs strong demand with tightening perimeters. Providers need licensed local entities (VASP, eFX, PSAV) and should model Brazil-style restrictions spreading to other regulated cross-border rails.

Sources: Chainalysis LATAM chapter; TRM Q1 2026; Rain via CoinDesk; Mastercard [65,75,34,14].

REGION · CHAPTER 07

# APAC: the largest payment region, built on corridors

Fragmented currencies, heavy trade corridors, real-time domestic rails and active regulators make stablecoins a cross-border bridge rather than a domestic payment method.

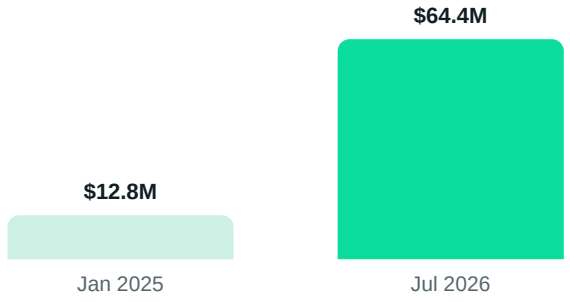
| INDICATOR | VALUE | PERIOD | SOURCE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Share of identified global stablecoin payment volume** | 51.2% | 2025–26 | CoinDesk / Allium [7] |
| **APAC-linked payment corridors identified** | 426 corridors · 28 countries | n/d | CoinDesk [7] |
| **Stablecoin payment volume in those corridors** | $30.9B · 14.2M txns | n/d | CoinDesk [7] |
| **USDT share of APAC payment volume** | 98% → 91% | Jan 2025 → Jul 2026 | CoinDesk [7] |
| **Non-USD stablecoin market cap (JPY, AUD, SGD, PHP, CNY)** | $12.8M → $64.4M | Jan 2025 → Jul 2026 | CoinDesk [7] |
| **Median delivery spread, APAC network** | 6.1 bps | Q2 2026 | Borderless.xyz [7] |
| **On-chain stablecoin activity in APAC** | $2.4T | Jun 2024–Jun 2025 | Circle (claim) |

## Largest identified bilateral flows

- Taiwan → Indonesia
- Taiwan → South Korea
- Taiwan → Australia
- Singapore ↔ China (cited by Circle, 2025)

## Non-USD stablecoins, APAC

USD millions




**WHY APAC MATTERS FOR USDC**

APAC is where regulators are building recognition pathways for foreign stablecoins (Japan, Australia, Singapore consultation), and where compliance-first coins gain share from a low base. Documented Circle relationships: JCB, Kakao (exploratory), SBI (Arc validator), Standard Chartered [1]. a16z attributed nearly two-thirds of Q1 2026 volume to Asia, mainly Singapore, Hong Kong and Japan [40].

Sources: CoinDesk Research APAC series (15 Sep 2026; Ripple-commissioned) [7].

APAC PROFILES

# Singapore, Hong Kong and Japan: three regulated hubs

## Singapore

Hub

| | |
|---|---|
| MARKET | Named by Circle as a top global stablecoin hub; regional issuers include StraitsX (XSGD, XUSD) [7] |
| PAYMENTS | Treasury, cross-border B2B, merchant acceptance via licensed firms (Nium, dtcpay, TripleA) |
| RAILS | PayNow, FAST; MAS Project BLOOM for multi-currency settlement |
| RULES | MAS Single-Currency Stablecoin Framework; 2026 consultation on legislation incl. limited foreign-stablecoin recognition [7] |

## Hong Kong

Licensing

| | |
|---|---|
| MARKET | Active licensing phase; tokenized deposits and Project Ensemble in parallel [7] |
| PAYMENTS | Institutional settlement, tokenized assets, cross-border treasury |
| RAILS | FPS, CHATS |
| RULES | Stablecoins Ordinance effective Aug 2025; HKMA's first licences to Anchorpoint Financial and HSBC in Apr 2026; no equivalence pathway for foreign issuers [7] |

## Japan

#4

| | |
|---|---|
| MARKET | Chainalysis #4 overall, #4 cross-border [65]; KRW and JPY >90% of APAC fiat CEX spot volume H1 2026 [7] |
| PAYMENTS | JCB–Circle: cross-border treasury in USDC and in-store stablecoin payments for visitors (announced) [1] |
| RAILS | Zengin, cards, QR |
| RULES | Issuance limited to banks, trust companies and fund-transfer providers; foreign trust-type stablecoins via registered intermediaries; SBI VC Trade distributes USDC [7,38] |

THE RECOGNITION QUESTION

Cross-border usability of USD stablecoins increasingly depends on equivalence: Japan's foreign trust-type pathway and Singapore's consultation versus Hong Kong's licensing without equivalence [7].

APAC PROFILES

# South Korea, China and Australia

## South Korea

#5

| | |
|---|---|
| MARKET | Chainalysis #5; #2 in balances [65]. Hana Bank took 6.55% of Dunamu (~$733M); Mirae Asset 97.15% of Korbit (~$103M) [70] |
| POLICY | 19 Jul 2026 roadmap (MOEF, FSC, BOK, FSS, KRX, KSD) pairs won internationalisation with a legal basis for won stablecoins [70] |
| LAW | FSC preparing one government Digital Asset Basic Act consolidating 10 bills (29 Jul); debated: banks ≥51% of issuing consortia, 15–20% caps for exchanges [70] |
| CBDC | Project Hangang Phase 2 in live-transaction testing; won stablecoin still lacks a legislative basis [70] |

## China (mainland)

#12

| | |
|---|---|
| MARKET | Chainalysis #12; #2 in domestic P2P despite the trading ban [65] |
| PAYMENTS | Corridor activity via Hong Kong and Singapore |
| RAILS | CIPS, UnionPay, Alipay/WeChat Pay; e-CNY |
| RULES | No private stablecoin pathway; state focus on e-CNY (background) |

## Australia

#15

| | |
|---|---|
| MARKET | Chainalysis #15; APAC corridors with low delivery cost [65,7] |
| PAYMENTS | Treasury and cross-border B2B |
| RAILS | NPP, PayTo, BPAY |
| RULES | Digital Assets Framework Act 2026; ASIC “exempt foreign issuer” relief; payment-stablecoin regime via SVF reform pending [7] |

Sources: Chainalysis; CoinGecko; CryptoNexa; Coinpedia; Seoul Economic Daily; CoinDesk Research [65,70,7].

REGION · CHAPTER 08

# Southeast Asia: a corridor market between strong QR rails

Inbound remittances (Philippines, Vietnam), outbound worker and trade flows (Indonesia, Thailand, Malaysia), and Singapore as the regulated hub.

| MARKET | CHAINALYSIS 2026 | DOMESTIC RAIL | STABLECOIN POSTURE | DOCUMENTED ACTIVITY |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Singapore** | — | PayNow / FAST | Regulated issuance hub (SCS) | XSGD/XUSD; Nium, dtcpay, TripleA [7] |
| **Thailand** | #8 (P2P #5) | PromptPay | Selected stablecoins for regulated activities | Strong remittance usage [7] |
| **Indonesia** | #14 | BI-FAST / QRIS | OJK supervises; rupiah legal-tender limits | Taiwan→Indonesia top corridor [7] |
| **Vietnam** | #18 (flows #7) | NAPAS 247 | Pilot crypto-asset framework (2025) | High retail adoption |
| **Philippines** | #19 | InstaPay / QR Ph | BSP VASP regime | Remittance-led usage [7] |
| **Malaysia** | — | DuitNow | Ringgit stablecoin RMJDT (Dec 2025) | Local-currency experiment |

## Chainalysis overall rank, SE Asia

lower is stronger




Bar length = 21 minus rank, for visual ordering only.

**LAST-MILE INFRASTRUCTURE**

Nium's Circle partnership connects USDC settlement through CPN to local-currency payouts across 190+ countries, directly relevant to SE Asian last-mile delivery [1].

**CARD PROGRAMS**

Rain expanded its Visa principal membership into APAC, with card launches expected from Q2 2026 [34].

Sources: Chainalysis 2026; CoinDesk Research APAC [65,7].

REGION · CHAPTER 09

# Africa: dollar substitution at grassroots scale

Sub-Saharan Africa led global crypto-economy growth in Chainalysis' 2026 period on exceptionally strong peer-to-peer activity. Nigeria ranks #1 worldwide for both P2P and cross-border flows.

## Nigeria #3

| | |
|---|---|
| INDEX | #1 P2P, #1 cross-border [65] |
| SCALE | $92.1B value received (Jul 2024–Jun 2025), nearly 3x South Africa [37] |
| USE | Dollar substitute amid FX shortages; USDT-led |
| RAILS | NIBSS Instant Payment |
| RULES | SEC oversight under ISA 2025 |

## South Africa #9

| | |
|---|---|
| INDEX | #3 cross-border, #4 P2P [65] |
| SCALE | Second in SSA by value received [37] |
| USE | Cross-border trade and treasury; more institutional |
| RAILS | RTC, PayShap |
| RULES | FSCA CASP licensing; cross-border framework pending |

## Kenya

| | |
|---|---|
| INDEX | Top-5 SSA market by volume [37] |
| SCALE | n/d for 2026 |
| USE | Remittances, freelancer income |
| RAILS | M-Pesa, PesaLink |
| RULES | VASP legislation enacted 2025 |

### Value received, Jul 2024–Jun 2025

USD billions




**STABLECOIN VS USDC DEMAND**

Stablecoin demand is structural: savings, imports, remittances, mostly USDT on Tron. USDC demand concentrates in fintech treasury and B2B settlement where regulated counterparties need attested reserves. No Africa-specific USDC share is published.

**MEASUREMENT GAP**

Earlier Chainalysis regional data captured centralized-exchange activity only; P2P and OTC, likely large, were excluded. The 2026 methodology adds domestic P2P, which is why Nigeria now ranks #3 overall. Yellow Card reports >$6B cumulative stablecoin volume across 35+ countries (secondary).

Sources: Chainalysis 2026 and 2025 via Mariblock [65,37].

CHAPTERS 10–11

# Middle East and Europe: licence-first markets

## United Arab Emirates

| | |
|---|---|
| MARKET | Regional hub; Circle holds an ADGM FSRA permission (Dec 2025) [38] |
| PAYMENTS | Digital-asset settlement must use fiat or a registered foreign payment token; USDU first registered (Jan 2026), reserves at Emirates NBD and Mashreq [38] |
| RAILS | UAEFTS, Aani; Jaywan domestic cards |
| RULES | CBUAE Payment Token Services Regulation; VARA, FSRA, DFSA |

## Saudi Arabia

| | |
|---|---|
| MARKET | No public stablecoin payment data located |
| PAYMENTS | Large outbound remittance market (background) |
| RAILS | SARIE instant payments, mada |
| RULES | No dedicated stablecoin regime identified |

## European Union

| | |
|---|---|
| RULES | MiCA titles since Jun 2024; CASP transition ended Jul 2026 |
| DATA | EURe fell from ~88% of crypto-card spend (early 2024) to ~2% (Jul 2026) [32] |
| RAILS | SEPA Instant mandated; TARGET2 |

## United Kingdom #17

| | |
|---|---|
| RULES | FCA PS26/10; gateway 30 Sep 2026–28 Feb 2027; regime live 25 Oct 2027; BoE £40bn guardrail [21,22] |
| DATA | #6 in service flows [65] |
| RAILS | Faster Payments, CHAPS |

## Switzerland

| | |
|---|---|
| RULES | FINMA Guidance 06/2024 (background) |
| DATA | No 2026 USDC payment data located |
| RAILS | SIC, SIC5 |

**EUROPE'S CURRENCY REALITY**

Germany ranks #13 (#5 in balances) in Chainalysis 2026. TRM finds EUR stablecoins under 0.3% of VASP volume but accelerating. Mastercard brought USDC/EURC settlement to EEMEA acquirers [65,75,42].

**DOMESTIC CASE IS NARROW**

SEPA Instant narrows the domestic stablecoin case; Europe's opportunity is cross-border and 24/7 treasury. Lloyds and Visa announced stablecoin settlement to speed cross-border payments [64].

SCORECARD

# 23 markets at a glance

Chainalysis = 2026 overall rank (— = outside top 20). USDC access = FurlPay Research qualitative judgement of regulated USDC usability for payments; not a forecast.

| MARKET | CHAINALYSIS | FRAMEWORK | USDC ACCESS | DOCUMENTED USDC ROUTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **United States** | 2 | GENIUS (law) | High | Settlement, distribution |
| **Brazil** | 1 | Res. 519–521, 561 | Medium | Licensed VASPs only |
| **India** | 6 | None; prohibition-leaning | Low | Offshore-leg only |
| **Nigeria** | 3 | ISA 2025 | Low–Med | USDT-led retail |
| **Japan** | 4 | PSA, bank-anchored | Medium | SBI, JCB |
| **South Korea** | 5 | DABA pending | Low | Kakao exploratory |
| **Singapore** | — | SCS framework | High | Hub; Nium/CPN |
| **Hong Kong** | — | Stablecoins Ordinance | Medium | No equivalence |
| **China** | 12 | No pathway | Very low | Via HK/SG |
| **UAE** | — | CBUAE PTSR | Medium | ADGM permission |
| **Saudi Arabia** | — | None identified | Low | n/d |
| **European Union** | Germany 13 | MiCA | High | MiCA-compliant |
| **United Kingdom** | 17 | FSMA; live 2027 | Medium | Pending regime |
| **Switzerland** | — | FINMA guidance | Medium | n/d |
| **Mexico** | 11 | Fintech Law | Low–Med | ARQ / Mastercard |
| **Argentina** | — | PSAV registry | Medium | Grupo Bind |
| **South Africa** | 9 | FSCA CASP | Medium | Treasury/B2B |
| **Kenya** | — | VASP Act 2025 | Medium | n/d |
| **Philippines** | 19 | BSP VASP | Medium | Remittance |
| **Indonesia** | 14 | OJK | Low–Med | Corridor payouts |
| **Thailand** | 8 | Selective | Low–Med | Regulated activities |
| **Vietnam** | 18 | Pilot framework | Low | n/d |
| **Australia** | 15 | DAF Act 2026 | Medium–High | Exempt foreign issuer |

Sources: Chainalysis 2026; regulatory sources per country pages [65].

PART III

# Networks, rails & use cases




37 Visa & Mastercard

39 Open USD

40 Circle & Arc

41 Stripe, Tempo, Coinbase

43 Cards & cross-border

46 AI-agent payments

47 Regulation, FurlPay, outlook


**15x**

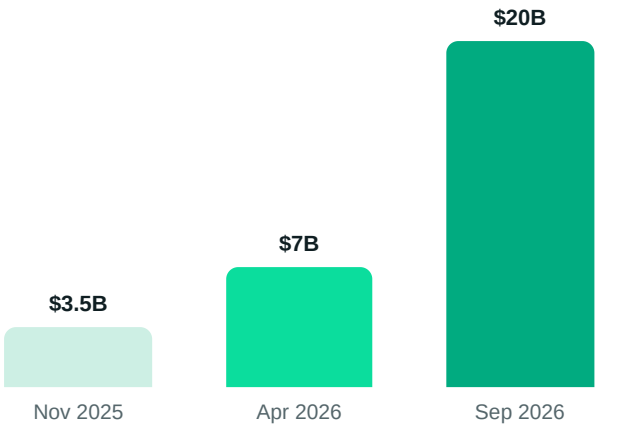
Growth in Visa's stablecoin settlement run rate in one year, to $20B [12]

NETWORKS · CHAPTER 12

# Visa modernises settlement, not checkout

### Stablecoin settlement run rate

USD billions, annualized




**STABLECOIN-LINKED CARD PROGRAMS**

**160+**

Payment volume ~+200% YoY [12]

**SUPPORTED BLOCKCHAINS**

**9**

After Apr 2026 expansion [11]

**SETTLEMENT WINDOW**

**7 days**

Issuers and acquirers settle VisaNet obligations weekends included [10]

| INITIATIVE | STATUS | DATE |
|---|---|---|
| **USDC settlement for US issuers/acquirers (Cross River, Lead Bank on Solana)** | LIVE | 16 Dec 2025 |
| **Global settlement program across LAC, Europe, AP, CEMEA ($20B run rate)** | LIVE | Sep 2026 |
| **Visa Stablecoin Platform (mint, custody, transfer); OUSD mint/redeem from launch** | NEW | Jul–Sep 2026 |
| **Founding partner and equity holder in Open Standard (OUSD)** | NEW | 30 Sep 2026 |
| **Onchain settlement financing with Credit Coop using VisaNet data** | PROPOSED | 8 Sep 2026 |
| **Arc founding validator; Tempo validator** | LIVE | 2026 |
| **Lloyds–Visa stablecoin settlement for cross-border payments** | NEW | Sep 2026 |
| **Bridge–Visa stablecoin-linked cards (Ramp, Squads, Airtm)** | LIVE | From May 2025 |

**OPTIONALITY, NOT REVENUE**

Visa books no separate stablecoin revenue line. Analysts note client incentives growing 18% YoY as a bigger near-term swing factor for take rate than stablecoin revenue [13,74].

Sources: Visa releases; Stablecoin Insider; Visa FQ3 2026; 24/7 Wall St; PYMNTS [10,11,12,13,74,64].

NETWORKS · CHAPTER 13

# Mastercard goes end-to-end: settlement, cards, BVNK, OUSD

**SETTLEMENT STABLECOINS**
**6**
USDC, PYUSD, USDG, USDP, RLUSD, SoFiUSD [14]

**BVNK ACQUISITION**
**$1.8B**
Up to; closed 3 Aug 2026 [15]

**SOFIUSD CARD SETTLEMENT**
**>$25B**
Expected annual volume (22 Sep) [64]

| INITIATIVE | STATUS | EVIDENCE / DATE |
|---|---|---|
| **Settlement in six stablecoins on Arbitrum, Base, Canton, Ethereum, Polygon, Solana, Tempo, XRPL; intraday, weekend and holiday windows** | LIVE | 3 Jun 2026; ARQ, CBW Bank, Cross River, Lead Bank, Nuvei [14] |
| **Merchant opt-in USDC settlement (Nuvei, Circle); USDC/EURC for EEMEA acquirers** | LIVE | From 2025 [42] |
| **BVNK acquisition (~$30B/yr processed for Worldpay, Deel, Flywire)** | LIVE | Closed 3 Aug 2026 [15] |
| **BVNK offers OUSD mint/redeem at par, no cost** | NEW | 30 Sep 2026 [63] |
| **SoFi settles card transactions on Mastercard with SoFiUSD** | NEW | 22 Sep 2026 [64] |
| **MTS US NYDFS BitLicense for stablecoin settlement** | LIVE | 2026 [47] |
| **Arc founding validator; Rain principal membership** | LIVE | 2026 [1,47] |
| **Multi-Token Network, Crypto Credential, Agent Pay** | LIVE | Background |

## Network settlement stablecoin support

| STABLECOIN | VISA | MASTERCARD |
|---|---|---|
| **USDC** | Yes | Yes |
| **PYUSD** | Pilot set | Yes |
| **USDG** | — | Yes |
| **RLUSD** | — | Yes |
| **SoFiUSD** | — | Yes |
| **USDT** | — | Not in Jun 2026 set |

Sources: Mastercard; The Block; Transak; PYMNTS; Blockhead [14,15,42,47,64,63].

NEW ENTRANT

# Open USD: the payment incumbents now co-own an issuer

On 30 September 2026, Open Standard launched OUSD with Coinbase, Mastercard, Shopify, Stripe and Visa as founding partners, each holding an equal initial equity stake.

**SEED LIQUIDITY**
**$1B+**
Committed by founding five [63]

**CONSORTIUM MEMBERS**
**100+**
Incl. Google, BlackRock (Bloomberg) [63]

**LAUNCH CHAINS**
**4**
Base, Ethereum, Solana, Tempo [63]

**MINT / REDEEM**
**1:1**
No cost via BVNK, Stripe, Visa [63]

## How OUSD reaches businesses

| PARTNER | ROLE AT LAUNCH |
|---|---|
| **Stripe** | Default stablecoin for businesses; Stripe Treasury balances; Stripe Issuing cards; sends to wallets in 100+ countries |
| **Visa** | Mint/redeem via Visa Stablecoin Platform |
| **BVNK (Mastercard)** | Mint/redeem at par |
| **Coinbase** | Trading at launch; mint access from October |
| **Kraken, Uniswap** | Trading venues |

**THE ECONOMIC SHIFT**

OUSD shares reserve earnings with participating businesses, giving banks, platforms and merchants a reason to distribute it. That challenges the issuer-keeps-the-float model used by USDT and, largely, USDC [64].

**THE PRECEDENT**

Paxos' USDG launched in late 2024 on the same pass-through promise and sits near $3.2B, so distribution economics alone do not guarantee scale [63].

## Implications

- **For USDC:** its two largest card-network partners now also own a competing coin; USDC remains the established settlement asset with 38 native chains and Arc.
- **For merchants and fintechs:** more competition for distribution means better economics for whoever controls end users.
- **For FurlPay:** multi-stablecoin support (USDC, OUSD, EURC) at the orchestration layer avoids betting on one issuer.

Sources: Bloomberg; Yahoo Finance; PYMNTS; Blockhead; Benzinga; Investing.com (30 Sep–1 Oct 2026) [63,64].

INFRASTRUCTURE · CHAPTER 14

# Circle's infrastructure stack and the Arc launch

## Circle Payments Network

end-Q2 2026

**ANNUALIZED**
**$14.7B**
+76% QoQ

**ENROLLED FIS**
**175**
+29% QoQ

"Enrolled" is not "transacting". Circle does not publish corridor-level or active-institution counts [1].

## Arc mainnet, 16 Sep 2026

**FOUNDING VALIDATORS**
**11**
Permissioned

**FINALITY**
**<1s**
<350ms benchmarks

Public testnet processed 700M+ transactions in under a year; PoS targeted for 2027 [67].

## Product stack

| PRODUCT | ROLE | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **USDC / EURC** | Regulated stablecoins on 38 native chains | LIVE |
| **Circle Mint** | Institutional issuance and redemption at par; 185+ countries | LIVE |
| **CPN** | Institution-to-institution payments, local-currency payout | LIVE |
| **CCTP** | Native cross-chain burn-and-mint | LIVE |
| **Wallets / APIs** | Programmable developer wallets | LIVE |
| **Agent Stack** | Agent payments; 900+ paid services (May 2026) | LIVE |
| **Arc** | USDC-gas L1; FX engine; opt-in privacy planned | LIVE |
| **ARC token** | 10B genesis mint; no public launch committed | TBC |
| **Circle National Trust** | OCC-chartered custody | LIVE |

**ARC FOUNDING VALIDATORS**

BlackRock, DTCC, Galaxy, ICE, Mastercard, MoneyGram, SBI Group, Standard Chartered, Sumitomo Corporation, Visa, Worldpay/Global Payments. At launch: Aave and Morpho lending; Binance, Kraken, Bybit, OKX access; BNY, HSBC, Société Générale and State Street among banks with access; BlackRock BUIDL and Circle USYC as tokenized collateral [67].

Sources: Circle Q2'26 results; Circle pressroom; Decrypt; Cryptopolitan; CoinReporter [1,39,67].

PROCESSORS · CHAPTER 15

# Stripe, Tempo and Coinbase: processors building the full stack

**STRIPE TPV 2025**
**$1.9T**
+34% [16]

**STRIPE VIEW OF 2025 STABLECOIN PAYMENTS**
**~$400B**
~60% B2B [16]

**TEMPO VALUATION**
**$5B**
$500M Series A [17]

| INITIATIVE | STATUS | DATE |
|---|---|---|
| **USDC acceptance; stablecoin payments for subscriptions** | LIVE | Oct 2024 / Oct 2025 |
| **Bridge acquisition ($1.1B); Bridge volume >4x in 2025** | LIVE | Early 2025 |
| **Stablecoin Financial Accounts in 101 countries** | LIVE | 2025 |
| **Open Issuance (custom stablecoins; BlackRock, Fidelity, Superstate reserves)** | LIVE | Sep 2025 |
| **Tempo L1 mainnet (Stripe/Paradigm); validators incl. Stripe, Visa, Zodia, MoneyGram** | LIVE | 18 Mar 2026 |
| **Machine Payments Protocol (HTTP 402) for agents** | LIVE | 2026 |
| **OUSD becomes Stripe's default business stablecoin** | NEW | 30 Sep 2026 |

## Coinbase

| DEVELOPMENT | DETAIL |
|---|---|
| **USDC distribution** | ~$19B average USDC on platform, Q1 2026; ~56% of USDC reserve income shared [35,71] |
| **Base** | x402 agent payments; 19% of crypto-card spend [32] |
| **x402** | 160M+ agentic payments in trailing year; donated to x402 Foundation (Linux Foundation) [35,36] |
| **Citi partnership** | Fiat-to-stablecoin business payments; CFTC clearinghouse approval (29 Sep 2026) [73] |
| **OUSD** | Founding partner; trading at launch [63] |

**WHAT PROCESSORS MEAN FOR ADOPTION**

Stablecoins become a payment method and treasury balance inside existing processor APIs rather than a separate crypto product. Merchants get stablecoin acceptance and payouts with no new integration [16].

Sources: Stripe letter via CoinDesk; Everstake; Spark; Blockhead; KuCoin/The Defiant [16,17,48,73,35].

BANKS · CHAPTER 16

# Banks become stablecoin rails

| BANK | INITIATIVE | TYPE |
|---|---|---|
| **BNY** | Primary USDC reserve custodian; USDC mint/redeem in Digital Asset Custody | Stablecoin access |
| **Standard Chartered** | Bank-led USDC mint/redeem; Arc validator | Stablecoin access |
| **Citi** | Coinbase partnership for fiat-to-stablecoin business payments (Sep 2026); Citi Token Services | On-ramp / deposits |
| **Lloyds** | Stablecoin settlement with Visa for cross-border payments | Network settlement |
| **Cross River, Lead Bank** | USDC settlement with Visa; early Mastercard participants | Network settlement |
| **SoFi** | SoFiUSD settles Mastercard card transactions, >$25B/yr expected | Bank-issued stablecoin |
| **HSBC** | Among first HKMA stablecoin licensees (Apr 2026) | Bank-issued stablecoin |
| **Hana, Woori (Korea)** | Dunamu stake; KRW stablecoin consortium preparation | Issuance prep |
| **Emirates NBD, Mashreq** | Reserve banks for USDU (UAE) | Reserve custody |
| **JPMorgan, Société Générale** | Kinexys deposit tokens; EURCV/USDCV | Tokenized deposits |

## Settlement assets compared

| | STABLECOINS | TOKENIZED DEPOSITS | WHOLESALE CBDC | CORRESPONDENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Issuer** | Licensed non-bank or bank sub | Commercial bank | Central bank | Commercial banks |
| **Ledger** | Public chains | Mostly permissioned | Permissioned pilots | Bank ledgers + SWIFT |
| **Hours** | 24/7/365 | 24/7 in network | Pilot-dependent | Banking hours, cut-offs |
| **Reach** | Global, open | Bank's clients | Participating CBs | Global via correspondents |
| **2026 maturity** | Production: cards, B2B | Production at select banks | Experiments (Hangang, Ensemble) | Incumbent |

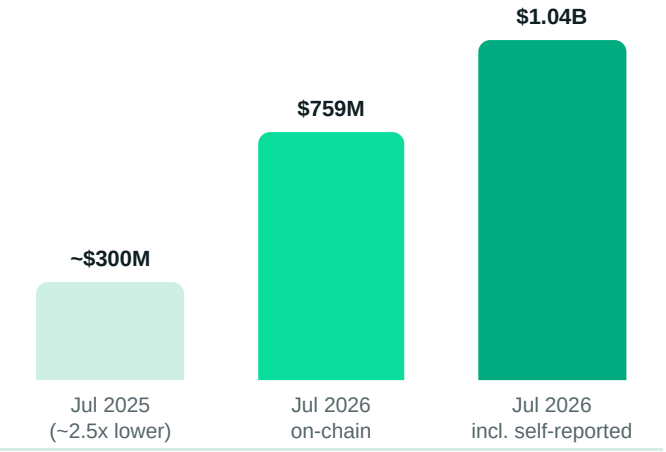
Sources: Circle; HKMA via CoinDesk Research; PYMNTS; Blockhead; CoinGecko [1,7,64,73,70].

CARDS · CHAPTER 17

# Stablecoin cards: the fastest consumer channel

## Monthly crypto-card spend

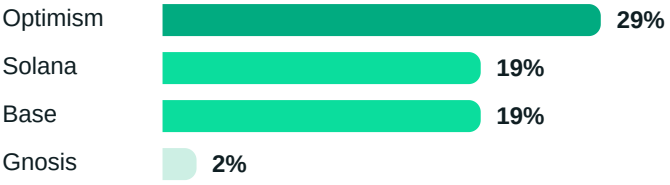
USD millions




## Spend by stablecoin




## Spend by chain




Jul 2025 bar derived from the reported ~2.5x YoY growth.

## Card lifecycle

**01 User USDC**
Self-custody or issuer balance

**02 Authorization**
Issuer checks balance, ~2s

**03 Conversion**
Issuer liquidity to fiat obligation

**04 Network**
Visa / Mastercard clearing

**05 Acquirer**
Merchant bank

**06 Merchant**
Receives fiat as normal

| MODEL | FUNDS HELD | EXAMPLES |
|---|---|---|
| **Custodial issuer balance** | Issuer holds user stablecoins | RedotPay ($395M/month self-reported), KAST |
| **Self-custody debit** | Smart-contract pull at authorization | Ether.fi, Gnosis-origin programs |
| **Card-as-a-service** | Partner wallets; issuer is principal member | Rain, Bridge–Visa, Stripe Issuing (OUSD) |
| **Exchange cards** | Exchange balance | Coinbase: ~16% of card volume involved USDC |

**ECONOMICS**

Consumers pay standard interchange-bearing card transactions; the stablecoin benefit accrues to the program operator through 7-day settlement and less prefunding. Rain reports trapped capital reduced by >40% in some cases. Average tracked ticket rose from $59 to $86, everyday spend rather than off-ramping [34,33].

Sources: a16z crypto (Paymentscan); CoinDesk; Rain [32,33,34].

ECONOMICS · CHAPTER 18

# Cross-border: the stablecoin sandwich vs correspondent banking

### Correspondent banking

- **Sender** · initiates wire
- **Originating bank** · compliance, FX quote
- **Correspondents** · nostro/vostro prefunding
- **FX conversion** · spread + fees
- **Beneficiary bank** · cut-off dependent
- **Recipient** · T+1 to T+3

### Stablecoin sandwich

- **Sender** · fiat in
- **On-ramp** · licensed provider → USDC
- **Blockchain** · seconds–minutes, 24/7
- **Liquidity / FX** · local-currency conversion
- **Off-ramp** · Pix, UPI, SEPA, PayNow
- **Recipient** · same day if rails open

| DIMENSION | CORRESPONDENT | STABLECOIN | CAVEAT |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Settlement time** | 1–3 business days | Seconds to minutes | Limited by on/off-ramp hours |
| **Operating hours** | Banking hours | 24/7/365 | Fiat legs bound by domestic rails |
| **FX** | Bank spread | Still needed at off-ramp | APAC median 6.1 bps [7] |
| **Liquidity** | Prefunded nostros | Just-in-time possible | Needs deep local liquidity |
| **Cost savings** | — | 41% of users ≥10% [53] | Survey-based |
| **Compliance** | Mature KYC/AML | Travel Rule, analytics | Rules diverge (Brazil 561) [62] |
| **Finality** | Recalls possible | Final; issuer can freeze | Disputes off-chain |
| **Capital** | Trapped in prefunding | Lower prefunding | Rain: >40% reduction [34] |

**REAL DEPLOYMENTS**

Nium USDC settlement via CPN into 190+ countries; Corpay using RLUSD for APAC funding; Polygon app payments >$2B in Jan 2026 (Revolut, Tazapay, Avenia); Lloyds–Visa cross-border settlement; Chainalysis' average cross-border stablecoin transfer is ~$3,000 [1,7,41,64,65].

Sources: As cited.

USE CASES · CHAPTERS 19–21

# Merchant payments, treasury and remittances

B2B, 2025
**$226B**
Largest segment [8]

C2C, 2025
**$77B**
Remittance proxy; 0.37% penetration [8]

C2B, 2025
**$76B**
Mostly platform collections [8]

## Merchant payments: the least mature use case

| MODEL | MERCHANT RECEIVES | SCALE EVIDENCE |
|---|---|---|
| **Stablecoin-linked card** | Fiat | $759M/month [32] |
| **Processor checkout (Stripe ~1.5% flat, PayPal)** | USD or stablecoin | Not disclosed |
| **Merchant opt-in USDC settlement (Mastercard/Nuvei)** | USDC | Not disclosed [42] |
| **Shopify via OUSD consortium** | TBD | Founding partner, Sep 2026 [63] |
| **In-store visitor payments (JCB–Circle, Japan)** | TBD | Announced [1] |

### Treasury & B2B

24/7 intercompany transfers and just-in-time funding; Marex accepts USDC initial margin; tokenized RWAs reached $27.9B at end-Q2 2026; BlackRock BUIDL and USYC serve as collateral on Arc [1,7,67].

### Payroll & payouts

Deel and Flywire among BVNK clients; Nium connects USDC settlement to 190+ payout countries; Stripe sends OUSD to wallets in 100+ countries [15,1,63].

### Remittances

Overwhelmingly USDT-denominated in emerging markets. USDC participates through licensed payout networks (Nium via CPN; MoneyGram, an Arc validator with its own MGUSD) [1,47].

### The last-mile constraint

Where cash-out, liquidity and licensing are missing or restricted (India; Brazil eFX from 1 Oct), stablecoins shift rather than eliminate cost [23,62].

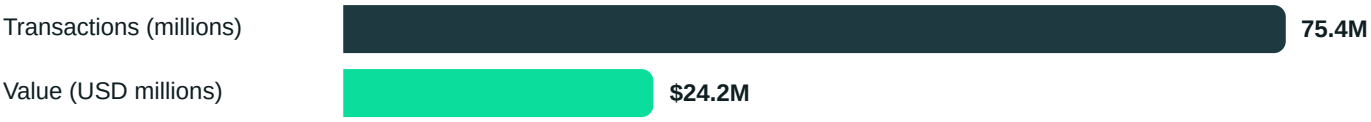
Sources: McKinsey & Artemis; a16z; Circle; Mastercard; Open Standard coverage [8,32,1,42,63].

EMERGING · CHAPTER 22

# AI-agent payments: most announced, least monetised

| X402 VOLUME IN USDC | X402 TXNS, 30 DAYS | VALUE, SAME WINDOW | AVERAGE PAYMENT |
|---|---|---|---|
| 99.3% | 75.4M | $24.2M | ~$0.32 |
| Circle claim [1] | Mid-2026 [36] | [36] | Derived [36] |

## Value vs transactions, one 30-day window




| PROTOCOL / PRODUCT | OWNER | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **x402 (HTTP 402 payments)** | Coinbase → x402 Foundation (Linux Foundation, 14 Jul 2026; Visa, Mastercard, Stripe premier members) | LIVE |
| **Machine Payments Protocol** | Stripe / Tempo | LIVE |
| **Agentic Commerce Protocol** | Stripe & OpenAI | LIVE |
| **Agent Stack (900+ paid services)** | Circle | LIVE |
| **Arc “agentic economic activity”** | Circle, mainnet Sep 2026 | LIVE |
| **Agentic Ready / Agent Pay** | Visa / Mastercard (card-based) | PROPOSED |

### Commercially deployed

API and data micropayments; programmable wallets with spending limits; pay-per-call content and compute.

### Still experimental

Agents earning revenue; autonomous procurement; agent identity standards; dispute handling for machine payments.

**READ THE 99.3% CAREFULLY**

Accurate but small in absolute terms. Early x402 volume was inflated by a memecoin mint; by early 2026, transfers above $1 were 95% of value. Coinbase reports 160M+ agentic payments in a trailing year [36,35]. Treat as developer-platform optionality.

Sources: Circle; Forkast; Coinbase via The Defiant [1,36,35].

REGULATION · CHAPTER 23

# Regulation: convergence in the core, divergence at the edges

| JURISDICTION | FRAMEWORK | LICENSING | KEY IMPLICATION |
|---|---|---|---|
| **US** | GENIUS Act (2025); Treasury IFR 30 Sep 2026 | Federal/state PPSI; $10B line | Effective by 18 Jan 2027 |
| **EU** | MiCA | EMI / CASP | Non-compliant coins restricted |
| **UK** | FSMA; FCA PS26/10 | Gateway Sep 2026–Feb 2027 | Live 25 Oct 2027 |
| **Singapore** | SCS framework + PSA | MPI licence | Foreign recognition consulted |
| **Hong Kong** | Stablecoins Ordinance | HKMA issuer licence | No equivalence path |
| **Japan** | Payment Services Act | Bank / trust / EPI | Foreign trust-type pathway |
| **South Korea** | DABA (pending) | FSC licence; bank-led | Phase-2 law in H2 2026 plan |
| **India** | None | PA-CB for fiat legs | Prohibition-leaning |
| **UAE** | CBUAE PTSR | Payment token licence | Registered-token rule |
| **Brazil** | Res. 519–521, 561 | VASP by 30 Oct 2026 | eFX stablecoin ban 1 Oct |
| **Australia** | DAF Act 2026 | AFSL extension | Exempt foreign issuer relief |
| **Nigeria / S. Africa** | ISA 2025 / FSCA CASP | SEC / CASP licence | Cross-border rules pending |

## Timeline

**2025**
GENIUS Act signed (Jul); HK Ordinance (Aug); Brazil Res. 519–521 (Nov)

**H1 2026**
OCC NPRM; Tempo mainnet; HKMA licences; BoE/FCA final rules; Mastercard settlement

**Q3 2026**
CLARITY fails (15 Sep); Arc mainnet; Fed proposals; Treasury IFR (30 Sep)

**Q4 2026**
Brazil Res. 561 (1 Oct); SEC comment close 20 Oct; OCC final rule (Nov target)

**2027**
GENIUS effective 18 Jan; UK regime 25 Oct; Arc PoS target

**THE RECOGNITION QUESTION**

Cross-border usability of USD stablecoins increasingly depends on equivalence: GENIUS comparable-regime determinations, Australia's exempt-foreign-issuer relief, Japan's trust-type pathway and Singapore's consultation, versus Hong Kong's licensing without equivalence and Brazil's rail-level restrictions.

Sources: OCC, Treasury, Fed, BoE, FCA, CoinDesk Research, Reuters via Payment Expert, BCB, The Block, CNBC [18–23,28,38,59,60,68]. Summaries only; not legal advice.

POSITIONING

# Where FurlPay fits in the stablecoin stack

FurlPay's product capabilities were not provided with this brief and no public documentation was located, so this page maps market requirements only. Each module is marked To be confirmed until checked against the product.

| MODULE | MARKET REQUIREMENT | RELEVANT INFRASTRUCTURE | DEPENDENCY | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Payments** | Stablecoin acceptance & payouts | Circle APIs/CPN, Bridge, BVNK | Licensed off-ramps per market | TBC |
| **Banking** | Fiat accounts, virtual IBANs | Partner bank / EMI | Banking licence or BaaS | TBC |
| **Cards** | Stablecoin-linked card program | Rain, Bridge (principal members) | Program manager approval | TBC |
| **Travel** | Cross-border spend, FX | Card networks, FX partners | Consumer & card rules | TBC |
| **Investments** | Tokenized MMF / RWA access | USYC, BUIDL, custodians | Securities regulation | TBC |
| **Developer SDK** | Wallet and payment APIs | Circle Wallets, CCTP | Developer KYB, AML | TBC |
| **x402 / MCP** | Agent payments & tool access | x402 Foundation, Agent Stack, MPP | Spend limits, agent identity | TBC |
| **Settlement** | Treasury in USDC / OUSD | Circle Mint, bank mint/redeem, Arc | Counterparty diligence | TBC |
| **Cross-border** | Corridor payouts | Nium, Thunes, local PSPs | India PA-CB; Brazil VASP/eFX | TBC |
| **Self-custody** | User-controlled wallets | MPC / smart accounts | Travel Rule, unhosted wallets | TBC |

**FurlPay · experience + orchestration layer**
Move money globally with digital dollars

**Stablecoins**
USDC · EURC · OUSD · CCTP · Arc

**Cards**
Visa / Mastercard via program manager

**Banking**
Partner banks · fiat rails

**Chains**
Base, Solana, Ethereum, Arc, Tempo

**Processor / issuer**
Rain, Bridge, BVNK

**Local rails**
UPI, Pix, SEPA, FPS, PayNow

## Where market evidence is strongest for an infrastructure company

01 **Card programs with stablecoin settlement:** $759M/month observed spend, 160+ Visa programs, white-label principal issuers [32,12].

02 **B2B cross-border payouts:** the largest real use case ($226B), with CPN/Nium and BVNK as licensed rails [8,1,15].

03 **Multi-stablecoin orchestration:** OUSD and bank coins fragment issuance; routing across USDC, OUSD and EURC is a defensible layer [63].

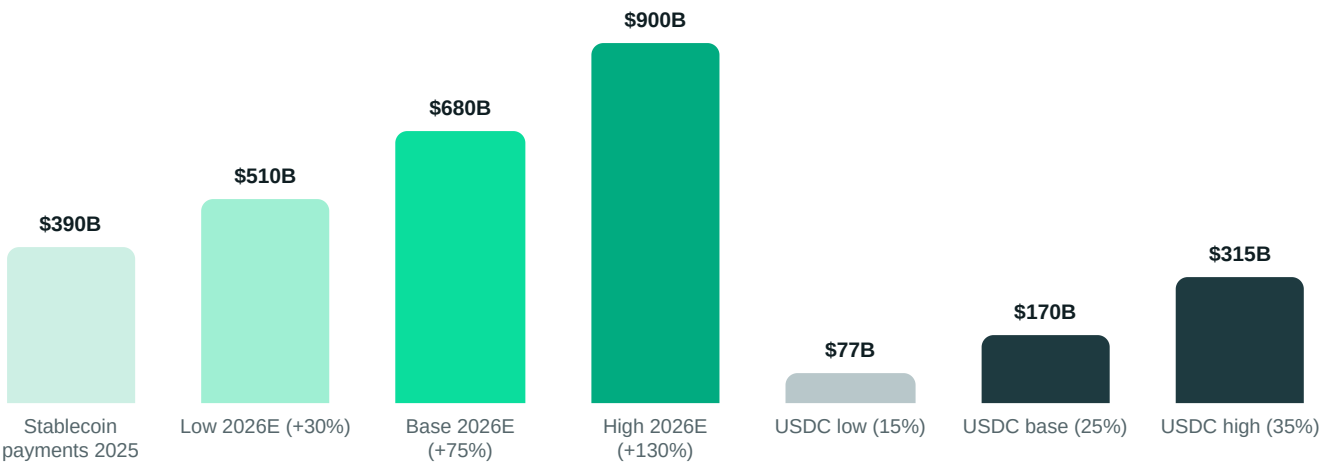
04 **India corridor:** real demand; only offshore-leg, PA-CB-partnered models are viable today [24,69].

OUTLOOK · CHAPTER 24

# Outlook 2026–2030 and the 2026E scenario model

## 2026E USDC payment volume scenarios

USD billions · MODEL




| LAYER | VALUE | BASIS | LABEL |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Total stablecoin supply** | $300.9B | RWA Foundation, 1 Oct 2026 [56] | INDEPENDENT |
| **Raw transfer volume** | $33T (2025) | Artemis [41] | INDEPENDENT |
| **Adjusted transfer volume** | $10.8T (2025) | Visa/Allium [9] | SECONDARY |
| **Cross-border stablecoin flows** | $220.3B (Jul 25–Jun 26) | Chainalysis, lower bound [65] | INDEPENDENT |
| **Stablecoin payment volume** | $390B (2025) | McKinsey/Artemis [8] | ESTIMATE |
| **USDC payment volume, 2026E** | $77B / $170B / $315B | USDC share 15 / 25 / 35% | MODEL |

**SHARE RATIONALE**

USDC is ≤9% of APAC payments and 7.1% of Brazil's declared volume, but 58% of card spend and ~67–70% of filtered volume. A 15–35% blended payment share reflects that range. The unverified $6.5T draft figure is excluded (~40x our base case).

**2027–2030: WHAT TO WATCH**

GENIUS effective 18 Jan 2027 and OCC licensing; equivalence between US, EU, UK and APAC regimes; OUSD and bank coins vs USDC for distribution; Arc and Tempo at production volume; Korea's won stablecoin law; any Indian policy decision; spread of Brazil-style rail restrictions.

2030 values are not projected numerically: no primary source publishes a payment-volume forecast, and compounding a one-year estimate four more years adds false precision.

PART IV

# Market structure, liquidity & risk





51 Paxos & Global Dollar Network

53 Issuer economics from SEC filings

54 Audits & attestations

55 Market makers & DeFi liquidity

57 The yield wall & tokenized cash

59 Cross-chain, privacy, depeg risk

62 Cost economics & addendum check


**58.5%**

Share of Circle's Q2 2026 revenue paid out as distribution and transaction costs [83]

ISSUERS · CHAPTER 25

# Paxos: the issuer-as-a-service model

Paxos issues stablecoins for partners (PayPal, the Global Dollar Network) through separately regulated entities in New York, Singapore, the EU and Abu Dhabi, with reserves held in segregated, bankruptcy-remote accounts.

| ENTITY | REGULATOR | ISSUES | 2026 STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Paxos Trust Company** | NYDFS trust; OCC conditional approval to convert to national trust bank (12 Dec 2025) | PYUSD (PayPal), USDP, PAXG | Converting to Paxos Trust Company, N.A. [82] |
| **Paxos Digital Singapore Pte. Ltd.** | MAS, Major Payment Institution | USDG | Live; attested by Enrome LLP [80] |
| **Paxos Issuance Europe** | FIN-FSA (Finland), MiCA EMT | USDG in the EEA | Live [78] |
| **Paxos International** | FSRA, ADGM (Abu Dhabi) | USDL Lift Dollar (yield-bearing) | Wound down: minting stopped 8 Oct 2025; redemption by Dec 2025 [79] |

## Paxos stablecoin lineage

**2019–2023 · BUSD**
Issued for Binance; NYDFS ordered new minting halted Feb 2023; wind-down

**Aug 2023 · PYUSD**
PayPal USD launched; issued by Paxos Trust

**Jun 2024 · USDL**
Rebasing, yield-paying coin from ADGM; not offered in the US

**Nov 2024 · USDG**
Global Dollar Network launched with partner revenue sharing

**Oct 2025 · USDL ends**
Paxos cites sharper focus; minting stopped

**WHY THE MODEL MATTERS**

Paxos runs issuance, reserves, attestation and regulatory compliance while the brand owner or consortium handles distribution. The same pattern now appears in Stripe's Open Issuance and in bank-issued coins such as SoFiUSD [48,64].

**ON USDL'S WIND-DOWN**

Paxos' stated reason was to sharpen focus as the market matured. Regulatory limits on holder yield (GENIUS in the US, MiCA in the EU) are a plausible context, but Paxos did not cite them; treat that link as interpretation [79].

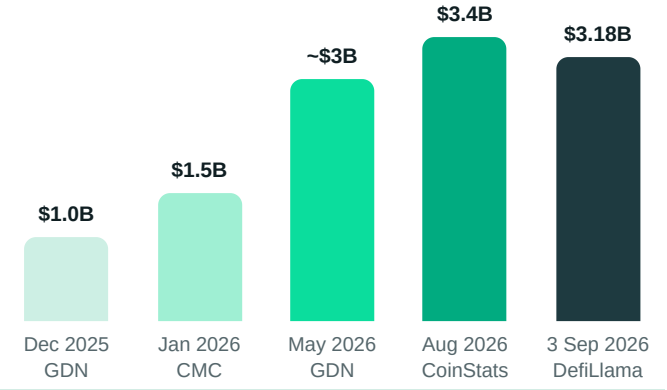
Sources: Paxos newsroom and transparency pages; GDN release; Steptoe, Axios, The Block on OCC approvals [78,79,80,82].

CHAPTER 25 · CONTINUED

# PYUSD and USDG: two Paxos coins, two distribution models

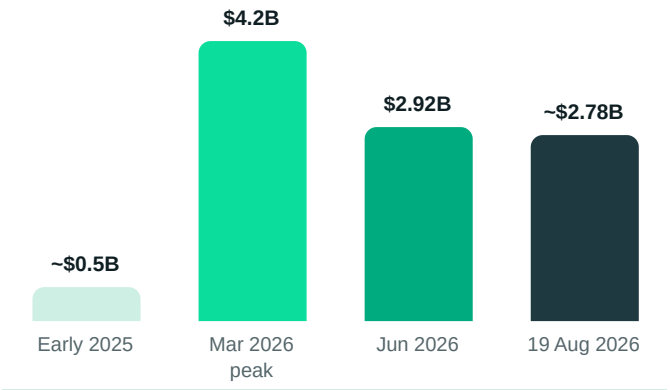
## USDG supply

USD billions; GDN and trackers




## PYUSD supply

USD billions




| | PYUSD | USDG |
|---|---|---|
| **Issuer** | Paxos Trust Company (NYDFS; OCC N.A. conversion) | Paxos Digital Singapore (MAS); Paxos Issuance Europe (MiCA) |
| **Distribution** | PayPal and Venmo; 70 countries from 17 Mar 2026; Solana default network since Feb 2026 | Global Dollar Network: 100+ partners (Dec 2025), 130+ (May 2026), 150+ (Jul–Sep 2026) |
| **Who earns the float** | Paxos/PayPal; PayPal pays users ~4% rewards on in-app balances | Partners earn economics tied to the USDG they bring; split not public |
| **Named partners** | PayPal, Venmo; PYUSDx framework with MoonPay and M0 (Feb 2026) | Robinhood, Kraken, Anchorage, Bullish, Galaxy, Nuvei, Mastercard, OKX, Worldpay, Mantle |
| **Liquidity** | Supply contracted 31% from peak by June 2026 | Market makers Keyrock, B2C2, JST Digital; OKX unified USD order book |
| **Attestation** | Monthly, KPMG LLP (since 28 Feb 2025) | Monthly, Enrome LLP (ISCA standards, MAS) |

**TRACKER CAUTION**

USDG figures differ by source: DefiLlama showed ~$3.18B on 3 Sep 2026 while GDN cited ~$3.5B; rwa.xyz lists $1.67B for the Singapore issuer alone (28 Sep). Early 2026 reporting also found the top 100 wallets held almost all USDG, so headline supply overstates retail use [77,90].

FILINGS · CHAPTER 26

# Issuer economics from SEC filings: distribution takes most of the float

**CIRCLE REVENUE & RESERVE INCOME**
**$701.3M**
Q2 2026 (10-Q) [83]

**DISTRIBUTION & TRANSACTION COSTS**
**$410.4M**
58.5% of revenue [83]

**CIRCLE OPERATING INCOME**
**$34.4M**
Net income cont. ops $48M [83]

**RLDC MARGIN**
**41%**
+302 bps YoY [83]

## Coinbase USDC economics

Q2 2026 earnings deck, SEC 8-K

| METRIC | Q2'25 | Q1'26 | Q2'26 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Avg USDC market cap** | $61B | $75B | $77B |
| **Avg USDC held in Coinbase products** | $14B | $19B | $20B |
| **Off-platform USDC** | $47B | $56B | $57B |
| **Stablecoin & corporate-balance revenue** | $332M | $324M | $320M |
| **of which on-platform** | $144M | $161M | $174M |
| **of which off-platform** | $188M | $163M | $146M |

## Circle Reserve Fund (USDXX)

10-Q

| DATE | HOLDING | SHARE OF RESERVES | YIELD |
|---|---|---|---|
| **31 Mar 2026** | $66.5B | ~86% | 3.59% |
| **30 Jun 2026** | $61.9B | ~84% | 3.57% |

A Rule 2a-7 government money market fund managed by BlackRock, custodied at BNY; Circle is the only shareholder; $2B minimum investment [83,84].

### Rate sensitivity (Circle 10-Q)

Each 1 percentage-point move in rates ≈ $737M of annual gross reserve-income exposure, offset by ≈ $360M of distribution-cost movement, using period-end balances and modeled partner terms [83].

### Coinbase deal renewed

Coinbase confirmed renewal on existing terms: 50% of revenue on USDC held off its platform and 100% on USDC held on-platform. Circle's own-platform share averaged 19.5% in Q2 vs 7.4% a year earlier [85,83].

**CONTEXT**

Coinbase reported Q2 2026 revenue of $1.2B (−19% YoY) and a $359M net loss; stablecoin revenue ($292.1M) was nearly half its transaction revenue line. Coinbase also says Base processed $32T of stablecoin transfer volume over the trailing 12 months (company claim) [85].

Sources: Circle Form 10-Q Q1 and Q2 2026, Q2 release; Coinbase Q2 2026 earnings deck (8-K) and 10-Q; BlackRock N-CSR [83,84,85].

ASSURANCE · CHAPTER 27

# Audits vs attestations: who checks the reserves

An attestation is a point-in-time examination of an issuer's reserve assertion. A financial-statement audit covers the whole entity over a period. Most stablecoins publish only the former.

| TOKEN | REPORT | FIRM | FREQUENCY | NOTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **USDC** | Reserve attestation | Deloitte & Touche | Monthly | Plus weekly mint/redeem and reserve data [97,54] |
| **USDC reserves (CRF)** | Fund financial-statement audit | Deloitte & Touche | Annual (FYE 30 Apr) | Unqualified opinion dated 23 Jun 2026; daily holdings on BlackRock site [84] |
| **Circle (issuer)** | Audited consolidated accounts | Registered public accountant | Annual 10-K, quarterly 10-Q reviews | SEC registrant since Jun 2025 IPO [83] |
| **USDT** | Reserve attestation | BDO | Quarterly | KPMG full audit engaged Mar 2026, not yet completed [66] |
| **PYUSD** | Reserve attestation | KPMG (Withum before 28 Feb 2025) | Monthly | AICPA standards; NYDFS-approved examiner [80] |
| **USDP** | Reserve attestation | KPMG | On request | Paxos no longer proactively publishes monthly [80] |
| **USDG** | Reserve attestation | Enrome LLP | Monthly | ISCA standards meeting MAS requirements [80] |

## What GENIUS and the OCC proposal require

### Monthly reserve reports

Permitted issuers publish reserve composition monthly, examined by a registered public accounting firm, with CEO/CFO certification [61,96].

### Annual audits above $50B

Issuers with >$50B outstanding that are not SEC reporting companies must publish audited annual financial statements [61].

### Segregation

Reserves held 1:1 in eligible assets, segregated from operating funds; redemption within two business days under the OCC proposal [61].

**WHY IT MATTERS**

USDC is the only large stablecoin whose issuer files audited SEC financials and whose main reserve vehicle has its own audited fund accounts. USDT relies on quarterly attestations while its first full audit is pending; Tether's reserves also include gold ($18.84B) and bitcoin (~$5.8B) [66].

Sources: Circle 10-Q; BlackRock N-CSR; Paxos transparency pages; Tether attestation coverage; S&P Global; Sullivan & Cromwell [83,84,80,66,97,61].

LIQUIDITY · CHAPTER 28

# Market makers: the peg's working mechanism

Primary mint and redeem at par plus secondary-market arbitrage keep fiat-backed coins near $1. Large mint and redeem flows show who does that work: Circle minted $83B and redeemed $87B in Q2 2026, and ~$10B a week each way in September [1,54].

**TOKEN BELOW $1**

1. Buy discounted token on venues
2. Redeem at par with issuer
3. Receive USD by wire
4. Buying pressure restores the peg

**TOKEN ABOVE $1**

1. Wire USD to issuer
2. Mint new tokens at par
3. Sell into the premium
4. Selling pressure restores the peg

Arbitrage profit = price gap minus fees, funding and settlement time; it is not riskless when redemptions are delayed or the issuer's solvency is in doubt (see page 61). Circle Mint redemptions were reported free below $40M of monthly net redemptions and 2 bps above (Mar 2026, secondary) [96].

## Principal liquidity providers named in stablecoin markets

| FIRM | BASE | DOCUMENTED STABLECOIN ROLE |
|---|---|---|
| **Wintermute** | London / Singapore | OTC desk: institutions 72% of spot OTC flow in H1 2026 (59% H1'25, 61% H2'25); added PAXG/XAUT OTC in Feb 2026 [86] |
| **Keyrock** | Brussels | Named USDG order-book liquidity provider by GDN [78]; Arc launch ecosystem market maker [67] |
| **B2C2** | London (SBI Group) | Named USDG liquidity provider [78] |
| **GSR, Galaxy, FalconX** | Global | Market makers named in the Arc launch ecosystem; Galaxy is an Arc founding validator and GDN founder [67,78] |
| **Flow Traders, Cumberland (DRW), Jane Street, Jump** | Global | Major trading firms active in crypto markets; no 2026 stablecoin-specific metrics located (background) |

**MEASUREMENT GAP**

No public dataset attributes stablecoin secondary-market volume to individual market makers. Firm reports (e.g. Wintermute's) describe their own desks, not the market. Claims about specific firms' shares of USDC or USDT liquidity should be treated as unverified.

Sources: Circle; Wintermute OTC report (30 Jul 2026) via Cointelegraph; GDN release; Spark; Arc launch coverage [1,54,86,78,96,67].

CHAPTER 28 · CONTINUED

# DeFi liquidity and TVL: stablecoins as collateral

**DEFI TVL**
**$95.4B**
26 Sep 2026, up 37.9% from $69.2B on 30 Jun [87]

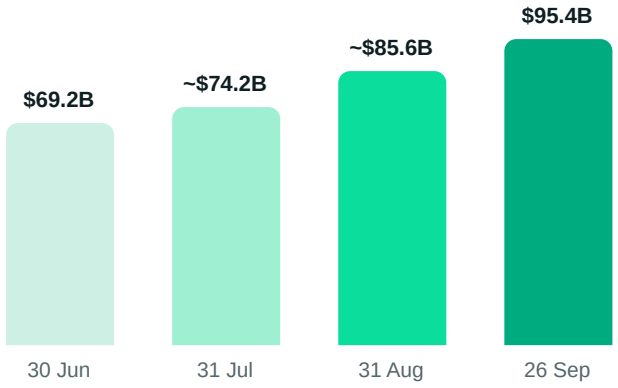
**DEFILLAMA STABLECOIN SERIES**
**$311.6B**
26 Sep; low $305.2B on 11 Aug [87]

**AAVE V3 TVL**
**$18.2B**
+53% in Q3; borrowing $12.6B [87]

**DEFI FEES, SEPT**
**$2.16B**
26 days; highest month of 2026 [87]

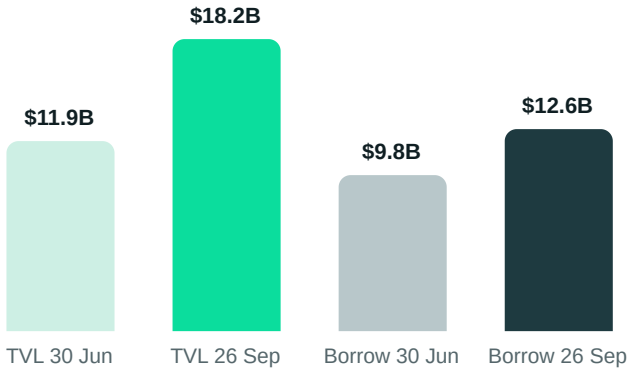
## DeFi TVL, Q3 2026

USD billions




## Aave V3, Q3 2026

USD billions




July and August points are derived from the reported monthly growth (+7.3%, +15.4%).

| VENUE | STABLECOIN-RELEVANT FACT |
|---|---|
| **Aave V4** | Launched on Avalanche (15 Jul) and Circle's Arc (16 Sep 2026); ~$1.16B supplied by Aave's count vs $0.64B on DefiLlama (methods differ) [87] |
| **Aave Horizon** | Tokenized-Treasury collateral market above $460M (secondary) [90] |
| **Sky (ex-MakerDAO)** | Over $2B of RWA collateral, with BUIDL among primary assets (secondary) [90] |
| **Pendle / Ethena** | Pendle held ~60% of USDe supply in Sep 2025, a yield-trading concentration (secondary) [91] |
| **Arc launch** | Aave and Morpho lending; Uniswap, Aero trading; USDC and EURC liquidity seeded by Circle [67] |

**WHY TVL MATTERS FOR PAYMENTS**

DeFi pools are where stablecoins are swapped between issuers and chains when no institutional desk is involved. Deeper pools mean tighter spreads for small transfers; large tickets still go through RFQ/OTC desks to avoid slippage and front-running.

Sources: Dwellir, State of DeFi Q3 2026 (DefiLlama data fetched 26 Sep 2026) [87].

REGULATION · CHAPTER 29

# The yield wall: payment coins cannot pay holders

PAYMENT STABLECOINS

**USDC · USDT · PYUSD · USDG · OUSD**

GENIUS: no permitted issuer may pay interest or yield "solely in connection with" holding, using or retaining the coin. MiCA bars e-money-token issuers and CASPs from granting interest (background). Reserve income stays with issuers or is shared with distributors.

YIELD-BEARING DOLLARS

**BUIDL · USYC · BENJI · USDY · sUSDe**

Regulated as funds or securities (or, for Ethena, a synthetic structure). Yield accrues to holders, but access is gated (KYC, qualified purchasers, non-US only) and they are not general payment instruments.

## The three-party loophole debate

| POSITION | ARGUMENT | SOURCE |
|---|---|---|
| **Congressional Research Service** | The ban may not reach the common model where the issuer shares reserve income with an exchange that pays customers rewards | CRS IF13174, 6 Mar 2026 [88] |
| **Banks (ABA, community banks)** | Extend the ban to affiliates and partners; any holding-based benefit should trigger it; deposit flight risk | Treasury ANPRM comments; Jan 2026 letter [89] |
| **Crypto industry** | Prohibition applies to issuers only; platforms may fund rewards | Treasury ANPRM comments [89] |
| **OCC proposal** | Rebuttable presumption against indirect yield via affiliates and related third parties (per Gibson Dunn analysis) | Feb 2026 NPRM [89] |
| **Deposit-risk estimate** | Up to $6.6T of bank deposits cited as at risk if yield programs persist (Treasury estimate, secondary) | [89] |

PAYPAL REWARDS ON PYUSD

**~4%**

Paid by PayPal on in-app balances [81]

COINBASE USDC REVENUE SHARE

**50% / 100%**

Off- / on-platform; funds USDC rewards [85]

CLARITY CLOTURE VOTE

**49–50**

Yield fight stalled talks for months [68,88]

IMPLICATION

Holder yield moves to the distribution layer (exchange rewards, consortium revenue sharing) or to fund-like tokens. How Treasury and the OCC finalize the anti-evasion language will decide whether platform rewards survive.

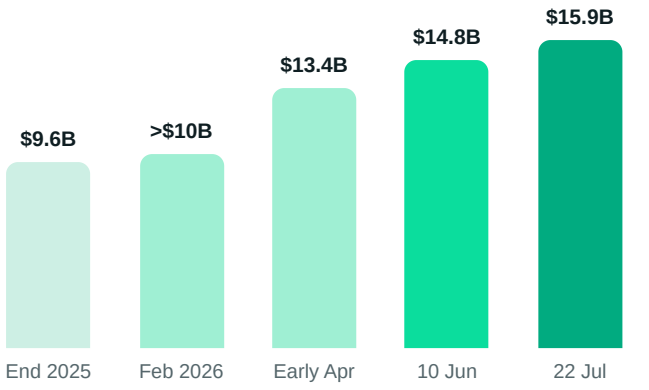
Sources: CRS; Cozen O'Connor; Cointelegraph; Blockeden; tech-insider (Gibson Dunn summary); PayPal; Coinbase [88,89,81,85].

RWA · CHAPTER 30

# Tokenized Treasuries and synthetic dollars

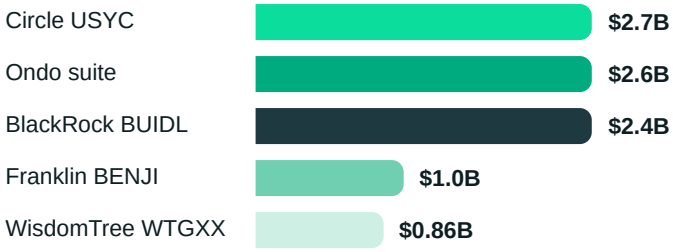
## Tokenized US Treasuries

USD billions, rwa.xyz




## Largest products, Q1 2026

AUM, USD billions




| PRODUCT | STRUCTURE | ELIGIBILITY |
|---|---|---|
| **BUIDL (BlackRock, Securitize)** | BVI private fund, Reg D 506(c) / 3(c)(7); multiple chains | Qualified purchasers; $5M minimum |
| **USYC (Circle)** | Tokenized money-fund exposure; Arc collateral | Non-US (Reg S); 100,000 USDC minimum |
| **BENJI / FOBXX (Franklin)** | US-registered 1940 Act government money fund | US investors via Benji onboarding |
| **USDY (Ondo)** | Yield-bearing note (Reg S) | Non-US persons only |

**TOKENIZED RWAS**

**$34.7B**

Distributed value, 22 Jul 2026 [90]

**ETHENA USDE SUPPLY**

**~$4.1–4.6B**

Sep 2026, down from ~$5.9B in Mar [91]

**SUSDE APY**

**~4.7%**

Aug 2026; $769M cumulative rewards [91]

**SYNTHETIC-DOLLAR RISK**

USDe earns yield from staking and perpetual-futures funding while hedging delta. In the October 2025 liquidation cascade it printed $0.65 on Binance's internal oracle while holding its peg elsewhere; Ethena disputes the depeg label. Ethena has proposed extending backing into equity perpetuals (Aug 2026) [95,91].

Sources: rwa.xyz via Investax, asset.haus, KuCoin; Ethena coverage via Stablecoin Insider and CoinStats [90,91,95].

INTEROP · CHAPTER 31

# Moving dollars between chains: burn-and-mint and intents

**CCTP CUMULATIVE**
**>$140B**
20+ chains, Apr 2026 [92]

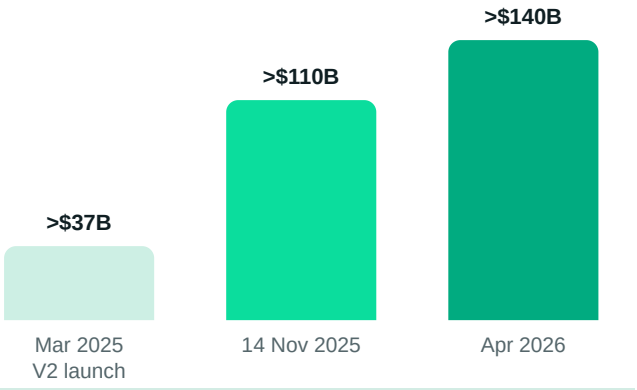
**CCTP 30-DAY VOLUME**
**$19.8B**
677,770 transfers, mid-2026 [92]

**USDC BRIDGE, 24H**
**$602.5M**
At launch, Apr 2026 [92]

**ACROSS VOLUME**
**>$35B**
Since 2021; no user funds lost (claim) [93]

## CCTP cumulative volume

USD billions




## Three cross-chain models

| MODEL | HOW IT WORKS | RISK |
|---|---|---|
| **Lock-and-mint bridge** | Lock on source; wrapped token minted on destination | Pooled contract is a hack target; wrapped-token depeg |
| **Burn-and-mint (CCTP)** | Issuer burns on source, mints native USDC on destination | Issuer attestation dependency |
| **Intents (Across, UniswapX)** | Solver fronts funds on destination, is repaid later | Solver bears rebalancing risk |

| MILESTONE | DATE |
|---|---|
| **CCTP V1 launch** | 26 Apr 2023 |
| **CCTP V2 (fast transfers, hooks) launch** | 11 Mar 2025 |
| **CCTP on Stellar (24 chains; MoneyGram ~475,000 locations on Stellar)** | May 2026 |
| **V1 phase-out begins** | 31 Jul 2026 |
| **ERC-7683 cross-chain intent standard (Across with Uniswap Labs)** | 2024–2026 |

**WHY IT MATTERS FOR PAYMENTS**

Native burn-and-mint removes wrapped-token risk for USDC, and intent networks give near-instant delivery because a solver, not the user, carries settlement risk. OUSD launched natively on four chains and USDG natively on Mantle, so multi-chain issuance is now the default [63,77].

Sources: Circle CCTP blog; GNcrypto; Bitcoin.com; Crossmint; range.org; Across blog [92,93].

PRIVACY · CHAPTER 32

# Confidentiality for business payments

Public chains expose balances, counterparties and amounts. For corporate treasuries this is a commercial-confidentiality problem; the 2026 tools encrypt amounts while preserving auditability.

| TECHNOLOGY | WHAT IS HIDDEN | WHAT STAYS VISIBLE | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Solana Confidential Balances (Token-2022)** | Balances and transfer amounts (ZK proofs, twisted ElGamal) | Accounts and participation; optional auditor key | LIVE Apr 2025 |
| **Solana Privacy Protocol (Helius “Rings”)** | Assets, amounts, participants per ring policy | Policy-defined auditor access | LIVE |
| **Circle Arc opt-in privacy** | Planned confidential transfers with view keys | — | PROPOSED post-launch |
| **Canton Network** | Sub-transaction privacy between permissioned parties | Parties to each transaction | LIVE in Mastercard set |
| **ZK rollups / validiums** | State transitions proven off-chain | Proofs on-chain | Mixed maturity |

### Compliance is built in

Confidential Balances supports an issuer-configured auditor key, so regulators or internal audit can read amounts while competitors cannot. Solana documents this as “confidentiality” rather than anonymity [94].

### Correction to the addendum

Arc did not launch with a live privacy engine on 16 Sep 2026. Privacy features and the move to proof-of-stake are planned for later upgrades [94,67].

ADOPTION EVIDENCE

No public data on confidential-transfer volume for USDC or other major stablecoins was located. Enterprise demand is widely asserted but not yet measured; treat confidentiality as a prerequisite to watch rather than a proven growth driver.

Sources: Solana Foundation docs; The Block; Chainstack; Arc launch guides; Mastercard [94,67,14].

RISK · CHAPTER 33

# Depegs and reserve stress: what has actually broken

| DATE | TOKEN | LOW | CAUSE | RECOVERY |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **May 2022** | UST | ~$0 | Algorithmic design failure | None |
| **10–13 Mar 2023** | USDC | ~$0.87 | $3.3B of reserves (~8%) at failed Silicon Valley Bank | ~3 days after US deposit guarantee (12 Mar) |
| **Mar 2023** | DAI | $0.88 | >50% USDC collateral | ~48 hours |
| **2 Apr 2025** | FDUSD | ~$0.87 | Public insolvency allegation (denied) | ~1 day |
| **Apr 2025** | sUSD | ~$0.68 | Collateral backstop removed | Yes |
| **Oct 2025** | USDe | $0.65 (Binance only) | Exchange oracle in liquidation cascade | Held elsewhere |
| **Mar 2026** | USR (Resolv) | $0.14 | ~$80M exploit; market cap −55.9% | No |

## SVB weekend, March 2023

- >$2B of DeFi loan repayments on 11 March, over half in USDC (Kaiko)
- ~3,400 Aave liquidations from $24M collateral, 86% USDC
- USDT and PYUSD did not depeg

## Reserve quality, 2026 (most to least liquid)

- Treasury repo and T-bills via a 2a-7 fund (USDC: ~84% in CRF)
- Short T-bills held directly
- Bank deposits (USDC: $7.1B on 21 Sep)
- Secured loans (USDT: $2.38B)
- Gold and bitcoin (USDT: $18.84B, ~$5.8B)

**WHAT GENIUS CHANGES**

Eligible reserves are limited to cash, insured deposits, short Treasuries (≤93 days), Treasury repo and government money funds, held 1:1 and segregated. The OCC proposal adds two-day redemption and requires issuers above $25B to hold 0.5% of reserves (up to $500M) in insured deposits. Gold, bitcoin and secured loans would not qualify for a US permitted issuer [61,89].

Sources: Spark and Simianx depeg tables; Cointelegraph/Kaiko; Kraken; Reap; Circle and Tether reserve data [95,5,54,66,61].

ECONOMICS · CHAPTER 34

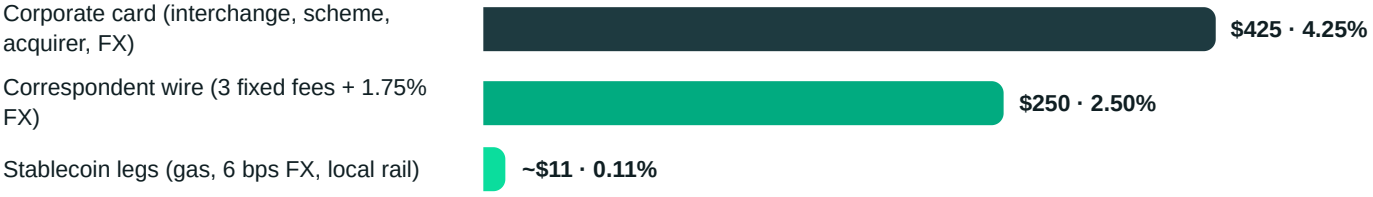
# Cost economics: what is measured and what is modeled

## Measured cost benchmarks

| BENCHMARK | VALUE | SOURCE |
|---|---|---|
| **UN SDG 10.c target for remittance cost** | <3% average; no corridor >5% by 2030 | World Bank SDG metadata [98] |
| **World Bank global average to send $200** | Above 6% in recent RPW editions (background) | Remittance Prices Worldwide [98] |
| **APAC stablecoin delivery spread (median)** | 6.1 bps, Q2 2026 | Borderless.xyz via CoinDesk [7] |
| **Firms reporting ≥10% savings from stablecoins** | 41% of users | EY-Parthenon survey [53] |
| **Circle Mint redemption** | Free below $40M monthly net; 2 bps above (Mar 2026) | Spark (secondary) [96] |
| **USDT average transfer cost (Tether claim)** | ~$0.01 per transaction | Chainalysis interview [65] |
| **Trapped-capital reduction (card programs)** | >40% in some cases | Rain [34] |

## Illustrative $10,000 cross-border payment

MODEL · assumptions from the addendum, not market averages




The stablecoin bar excludes any orchestrator, compliance or platform fee, which in practice sets most of the end-customer price. Card and wire assumptions vary widely by card type, corridor and bank.

**BOTTOM LINE**

Measured data supports large savings on the settlement leg and on prefunded capital. All-in end-customer savings depend on off-ramp liquidity, licensing and provider margins, which no public dataset measures consistently.

Sources: World Bank; CoinDesk Research; EY-Parthenon via Tazapay; Spark; Chainalysis; Rain [98,7,53,96,65,34].

VERIFICATION

# Checking the 3 October strategic addendum

Claims from the addendum were traced to primary sources. Verified facts are used in Part IV; others are corrected or excluded.

| ADDENDUM CLAIM | FINDING | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **GENIUS Act full name "Guiding Uniformity and Innovation…"** | Correct name: Guiding and Establishing National Innovation for U.S. Stablecoins Act | UNVERIFIED |
| **Paxos issues USDG under MAS and MiCA; USDL from ADGM** | Confirmed (Paxos Digital Singapore; Paxos Issuance Europe under FIN-FSA; Paxos International) | VERIFIED |
| **USDL deprecated because of MiCA/GENIUS yield rules** | Wind-down confirmed (Oct 2025); Paxos cited focus, not regulation | PARTIAL |
| **GDN: 100+ partners; partners get the "substantial majority" of yield** | 150+ partners by Jul 2026; revenue split not disclosed | PARTIAL |
| **Circle operates mainly under state money-transmitter licences** | Circle received final OCC national trust approval in 2026 | OUTDATED |
| **Payment issuers barred from paying holder yield (GENIUS, MiCA)** | Confirmed for issuers; platform rewards remain contested | VERIFIED |
| **Arc has a live native privacy engine** | Privacy planned for post-launch upgrades | UNVERIFIED |
| **USDC fell to $0.877 in March 2023; ~8.2% impairment** | Low ~$0.87; $3.3B ≈ 8% of reserves | VERIFIED |
| **Named market makers are the largest USDC/USDT liquidity providers** | No public dataset ranks them; roles partly documented | AMBIGUOUS |
| **JIT liquidity cuts trapped capital 40–65%** | Only Rain's ">40% in some cases" documented | PARTIAL |
| **Cost waterfall: card 4.25%, SWIFT 2.50%, stablecoin 0.26%** | Illustrative assumptions; kept as a labeled model only | ESTIMATE |
| **Tether Q2'26: $2.38B secured loans, ~$18.8B gold, ~$5.8B BTC** | Matches the BDO attestation coverage | VERIFIED |

**SCOPE NOTE**

Recommendations in the addendum aimed at FurlPay's own product roadmap are outside this global research report and were not added.

Sources: As cited across Part IV.

PART V

# Fiat rails, licences & virtual accounts




65 The licensing stack

66 MiCA after the transition

67 MiCA review & euro stablecoins

68 PSD2–MiCA interplay & PSD3

69 Virtual IBANs

70 Verification of Payee

71 Safeguarding

72 Canada: MSB, RPAA, Stablecoin Act


**244**

MiCA-authorised CASPs on ESMA's register when the transition ended, 1 July 2026 [104]

LICENSING · CHAPTER 35

# The licensing stack: what each permission actually allows

Stablecoin payment providers combine crypto licences, payment licences and banking partners. No single EU or Canadian permission covers the whole fiat-to-stablecoin flow.

| PERMISSION | REGULATOR | EXCHANGE CRYPTO↔FIAT | TRANSFER / CUSTODY EMTS | PAYMENT ACCOUNTS & IBANS | ISSUE STABLECOIN |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **MiCA CASP** | NCA, ESMA register | **Yes** | Limited (PSD2 licence also needed from 2 Mar 2026) | No (client funds placed with a bank or central bank) | No |
| **MiCA EMT issuer** | Credit institution or EMI + white paper | — | — | As bank / EMI | **Yes** |
| **Payment Institution (PSD2)** | NCA, EBA register | No | **Yes** (EMT transfers are payment services) | **Yes** (transactional only) | No |
| **E-money Institution (EMD2)** | NCA, EBA register | No | **Yes** | **Yes** (stored value) | **Yes** if EMT-authorised |
| **Credit institution** | NCA / ECB | Via CASP licence | **Yes** | **Yes** (deposits, DGS-covered) | **Yes** |
| **FINTRAC MSB (Canada)** | FINTRAC | **Yes** (AML registration) | **Yes** | No | No |
| **RPAA PSP (Canada)** | Bank of Canada | — | Stablecoins not yet prescribed | Holds end-user funds with safeguarding | No |

**THE CORE BOUNDARY**

A MiCA CASP licence covers crypto services such as exchange, custody and order execution. Since the EBA's June 2025 no-action letter, transferring EMTs for clients and running custodial EMT wallets are treated as payment services that also need a PSD2 licence or a licensed partner [105].

**WHAT CHANGES NEXT**

PSD3/PSR fold the e-money regime into payments law, merging PI and EMI authorisation, and give MiCA-authorised CASPs a streamlined route to payment authorisation. Adoption is expected in H2 2026, with application roughly 18 months later [107].

"Limited" means the activity is permitted only with an additional authorisation or partner. Simplified summary; not legal advice. The dossier's statement that a CASP has "zero permission to hold fiat" overstates the rule: CASPs may hold client funds linked to crypto services but must place them with a credit institution or central bank (MiCA Art. 70, background).

Sources: EBA No-Action Letter and Opinion; PSD3/PSR coverage; Bank of Canada; FINTRAC guidance [105,107,109,111].

MICA · CHAPTER 36

# MiCA after the transition: who is inside the perimeter

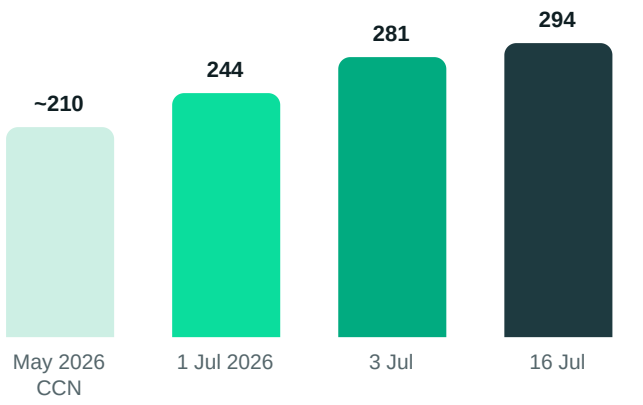
**AUTHORISED CASPS**
**244**
ESMA register at 1 Jul 2026 [104]

**REGISTER ENTRIES**
**294**
After 16 Jul update (+37, +14) [104]

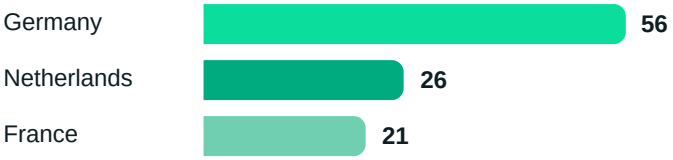
**EMTS / ARTS**
**39 / 0**
Issued / authorised at 1 Sep 2026 [106]

**NON-COMPLIANT LIST**
**164**
ESMA warning register, Jul 2026 [104]

## Authorised CASPs on ESMA's register




## Top home states, late June 2026




More than 1,200 entities were nationally registered before MiCA; ~17% had CASP authorisation by May 2026 (secondary). A third-party tracker that adds Norway counted 338 authorised CASPs on 26 Jul 2026 [104].

| DATE | MILESTONE |
|---|---|
| **30 Jun 2024** | Stablecoin titles (EMTs, ARTs) apply |
| **30 Dec 2024** | CASP regime applies; national transitional regimes begin |
| **17 Apr 2026** | ESMA confirms no extension; unauthorised firms need wind-down plans [103] |
| **1 Jul 2026** | Outer limit of all transitional periods (Art. 143(3)); unauthorised CASPs must cease EU services [103] |
| **20 May – 30 Sep 2026** | Commission targeted consultation on MiCA review (deadline extended from 31 Aug) [106] |
| **30 Jun 2027** | Commission review report due, possibly with legislative proposals (“MiCA 2”) [106] |

**IMPLICATION**

Liquidity that was spread across hundreds of nationally registered venues is consolidating onto a few hundred authorised CASPs. Counterparties and payment partners should check the ESMA register, which is updated weekly, before routing EU flows [104].

Sources: ESMA statements (Apr and Jun 2026); ESMA interim register via Elliptic, MiCA Crypto Alliance, Forklog, CV5 Capital, penning.io; EBA [103,104,106].

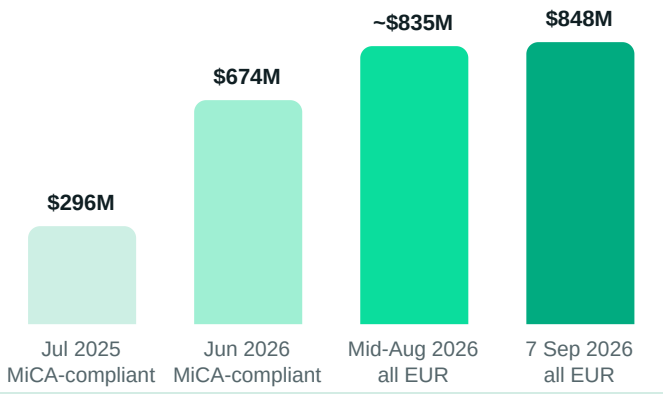
CHAPTER 37

# The MiCA review: multi-issuance and the euro stablecoin gap

| DATE | SOURCE | POSITION |
|---|---|---|
| **Sep 2025** | European Systemic Risk Board | Recommendation reading MiCA as not permitting third-country multi-issuance [106] |
| **10 Apr 2026** | ECB non-paper | Argues against third-country multi-issuance under MiCA [106] |
| **20 May 2026** | European Commission | Consultation acknowledges multi-issuance is not prohibited for all stablecoins; asks about an equivalence regime [106] |
| **24 Sep 2026** | EBA response | Third-country multi-issuer schemes pose “significant to very significant” risk; clarify scope, redemption timing and reporting; bring crypto lending into scope [106] |

## Euro stablecoin supply

USD millions




## Euro stablecoin shares, Sep 2026




USD stablecoins hold ~99.5% of global supply; euro stablecoins ~0.3%, roughly 350 times smaller (Token Terminal) [112].

EURO STABLECOIN GROWTH, 2026 YTD

**+22.6%**

~$156M added to 7 Sep [112]

WHY MULTI-ISSUANCE MATTERS

USDC and USDG are issued both by EU entities (Circle's French EMI; Paxos Issuance Europe) and by non-EU affiliates as one fungible token. If MiCA is read to bar this, EU holders could face redemption-location risk or separate EU-only tokens.

CORRECTION TO THE DOSSIER

The EBA's 24 Sep 2026 response is confirmed, but it addresses third-country multi-issuer schemes generally and does not name GDN or OUSD. No ESMA “investor protection proposal” dated 30 Sep 2026 was located; 30 Sep was the Commission consultation deadline [106].

Sources: EBA; European Commission; Skadden; Notabene; Regulation Tomorrow; Token Terminal via CoinTurk; Decta; CryptoBriefing [106,112].

PAYMENTS LAW · CHAPTER 38

# Where crypto law meets payments law: PSD2, MiCA and PSD3

**END OF EBA TRANSITION**
**2 Mar 2026**
CASPs transferring EMTs need a PSD2 licence or partner [105]

**CASPS APPROACHED NCAS**
**100+**
For payment authorisation since Jun 2025 [105]

**COMBINED CAPITAL**
**~€250k**
MiCA + PSD2 own funds accumulate (est.) [105]

| EMT ACTIVITY | PAYMENT SERVICE UNDER PSD2? | CONSEQUENCE |
|---|---|---|
| **Exchanging crypto for fiat or other crypto (incl. EMTs)** | No | MiCA only |
| **Intermediating crypto purchases paid with EMTs** | No | MiCA only |
| **Transferring EMTs on behalf of clients** | Yes | PSD2 licence or licensed partner; SCA; fraud reporting |
| **Custodial wallet that sends/receives EMTs to third parties** | Yes — a payment account | SCA on access; liability for unauthorised transactions (Art. 74(2)) |

## PSD3 / PSR timeline

**Jun 2023**
Commission proposes PSD3 (directive) and PSR (regulation)

**27 Nov 2025**
Provisional agreement; PSD2 and EMD2 to be replaced

**Apr–May 2026**
Final compromise texts; ECON committee approval

**H2 2026**
Formal adoption and Official Journal expected

**~2028**
PSR applies ~18 months after entry into force

### What PSD3/PSR change for stablecoin firms

PI and EMI licences merge; initial capital calibrated to risk; streamlined authorisation for MiCA CASPs; stronger fraud-liability and refund rules; platforms may only advertise authorised financial services [107].

### EBA long-term advice

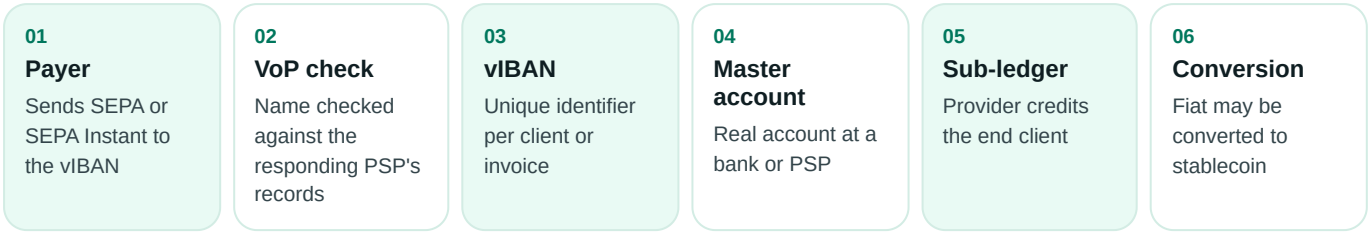
The EBA prefers that MiCA reproduce or cross-refer to PSD3/PSR rules so CASPs need only one licence, rather than permanent dual authorisation [105].

Sources: EBA No-Action Letter (10 Jun 2025) and Opinion (12 Feb 2026); Plesner; DLA Piper; CMS; McCann FitzGerald; Council via Taylor Wessing; MoFo; Worldline; PwC [105,107].

VIBAN · CHAPTER 39

# Virtual IBANs: useful plumbing, uneven supervision

The EU AML Regulation defines a virtual IBAN as an identifier that redirects payments to a payment account identified by a different IBAN. vIBANs look identical to ordinary IBANs, so third parties cannot tell them apart [102].




| ISSUE | EBA FINDING (MAY 2024) |
|---|---|
| **Scope** | Fact-finding across the EU; six common use cases; a dozen risks and challenges identified [102] |
| **Use cases** | Payment reconciliation; collection accounts; overcoming IBAN discrimination by using another country's IBAN code [102] |
| **ML/TF** | End users may be unknown to the account-servicing PSP and to counterpart PSPs (the “know your customer's customer” gap) [102] |
| **Regulatory arbitrage** | National authorities interpret AMLD, PSD2, CRD and the SEPA Regulation differently for vIBANs [102] |
| **Depositor protection** | Risks where the end user is not the master-account holder [102] |

### Pooled (reference) vIBAN

The account holder of record is the provider; the vIBAN routes into a pooled master account. Payer verification may show the provider's name, not the client's.

### Named vIBAN

The vIBAN is registered to the end client's legal name in the responding PSP's VoP data, so a payer typing the client's name can receive a match.

**WHAT'S COMING**

The AML Regulation, with its vIBAN definition, applies from July 2027; the accompanying directive expands national bank-account registers to cover virtual IBANs (background). Banca d'Italia's UIF has also flagged ML risks in some vIBAN types [102].

Sources: EBA Report on virtual IBANs, 24 May 2024; FIAU Malta; PwC Legal; A&O Shearman; Azienda Banca on UIF analysis [102].

VOP · CHAPTER 40

# Verification of Payee and the Instant Payments Regulation

**VOP LIVE, EURO AREA**
**9 Oct 2025**
SCT and SCT Inst; no phase-in for PIs/EMIs [99]

**SEPA INSTANT**
**≤10 s**
Funds available to payee [99]

**VOP RESPONSE**
**≤5 s**
Preferably within 1 second [100]

**VOP, NON-EURO EU**
**9 Jul 2027**
Member states outside the euro [99]

## Early VoP outcomes

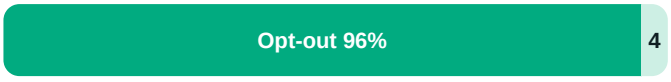
UniCredit Germany, Q4 2025–Q1 2026




Top no-match causes: address or location in the name field, abbreviations, incomplete company names, names too short. LUXHUB's platform reports 90%+ positive matches since Dec 2025 [101,100].

## Bulk files

UniCredit




Corporates may opt out of VoP for bulk SEPA credit transfers; 96% of bulk submissions did. Only 14% of instant-payment files opted in [101].

| DATE | INSTANT PAYMENTS REGULATION (EU) 2024/886 MILESTONE |
|---|---|
| **9 Jan 2025** | Euro-area PSPs must receive SEPA Instant; price parity with standard transfers |
| **5 Oct 2025** | EPC VoP Scheme Rulebook effective |
| **9 Oct 2025** | Euro-area PSPs must send SEPA Instant and offer VoP; non-bank PSPs can access TARGET/TIPS |
| **Mid-Jun 2026** | VoP Rulebook v1.1 effective (13 change requests) |
| **Nov 2026 / ~Nov 2027** | Rulebook v2.0 publication / expected effective date |
| **9 Jan / 9 Jul 2027** | Non-euro member states: receive instant / offer VoP |

**WHAT IT MEANS FOR STABLECOIN ON-RAMPS**

Pay-ins to virtual accounts now pass through a name check. A named account that returns “match” behaves like an ordinary corporate account; a pooled account may trigger close-match or no-match warnings. The dossier's claim of “over 40%” abandonment from no-match results was not found in any source.

Sources: ECB IPR page; McCann FitzGerald; Matheson; EPC; LUXHUB; UniCredit VoP webinar (May 2026); ABE/EBA Clearing [99,100,101].

SAFEGUARDING · CHAPTER 41

# Safeguarding: e-money balances are not deposits

Funds held by payment and e-money firms are protected by segregation or insurance, not by deposit insurance. Stablecoin reserve rules borrow the same logic with stricter asset limits.

| REGIME | PROTECTION METHOD | 2026 STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **EU PSD2 / EMD2** | Segregate in a separate account at a credit institution or in secure low-risk assets, or cover by insurance/comparable guarantee; no DGS coverage for the end user (background) | In force; PSD3 tightens and diversifies safeguarding [107] |
| **UK FCA PS25/12** | Daily reconciliations, annual safeguarding audit, monthly FCA returns, a designated senior individual | In force 7 May 2026 [108] |
| **Canada RPAA** | End-user funds in a trust account or covered by insurance/guarantee; written safeguarding framework | Obligations since 8 Sep 2025 [109] |
| **US GENIUS (stablecoins)** | 1:1 eligible reserves (cash, insured deposits, ≤93-day T-bills, repo, government MMFs), segregated; monthly examined reports | Effective by 18 Jan 2027 [61,19] |
| **EU MiCA (EMTs)** | Reserve funds deposited with credit institutions and invested in high-quality liquid assets; permanent par redemption right | In force since Jun 2024 (background) |

BANK DEPOSIT INSURANCE

**€100k / £120k**

EU DGS / UK FSCS limits — not available on e-money or stablecoin balances (background)

UK RECONCILIATION

**Daily**

Under the new safeguarding regime [108]

RPAA MAXIMUM PENALTY

**$10M**

Per violation; or revocation [110]

COMPARISON WITH STABLECOIN RESERVES

A virtual-account balance at an EMI and a USDC balance share the key property: the holder relies on segregation and the quality of the safeguarding bank or reserve assets, not on deposit insurance. The EBA's MiCA review response also asks to clarify the maximum time for EMT redemptions under normal conditions [106].

Sources: PSD3/PSR coverage; FCA PS25/12 via Bratby Law; Bank of Canada; payments.gi; Sullivan & Cromwell; EBA [107,108,109,110,61,106].

CANADA · CHAPTER 42

# Canada: FINTRAC MSB, the RPAA and the new Stablecoin Act

Canada ranks #10 in the Chainalysis 2026 adoption index. Three separate federal layers now apply to stablecoin payment firms [65].

| | FINTRAC MSB REGISTRATION | BANK OF CANADA RPAA | STABLECOIN ACT |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Law** | PCMLTFA (AML/ATF) | Retail Payment Activities Act | Bill C-15, Division 45 |
| **Purpose** | KYC, record-keeping, reporting, compliance programme | Operational risk, incident response, safeguarding, reporting | Fiat-backed stablecoin issuers: 1:1 reserves, par redemption, disclosure |
| **Status** | VC dealing covered since 1 Jun 2020; travel rule since Jun 2021 | Registration opened 1 Nov 2024; obligations from 8 Sep 2025; registry published Oct 2025 | Royal Assent 26 Mar 2026; not yet in force |
| **Cost / thresholds** | No registration fee; valid 2 years; LVCTR at CAD 10,000 | First annual report due 31 Mar 2026; penalties up to $10M | Bank of Canada as registrar and supervisor |
| **Stablecoins** | Exchanging/transferring VC requires registration | Not yet prescribed as a qualifying unit (Jun 2026) | Covers issuers once in force |

FINTRAC PENALTIES
**$205M+**
25 MSB penalties, 2020–2025 (MNP analysis) [111]

LARGEST CRYPTO PENALTY
**~CAD 177M**
Virtual-currency platform, Oct 2024 [111]

MSB REVOCATIONS, 2026
**164**
To Sep; 125 listed VC dealing [111]

CHAINALYSIS RANK
**#10**
Canada, 2026 index [65]

### THE REGISTRATION DISTINCTION

FINTRAC registration is an AML registration, not a prudential licence; FINTRAC states it does not endorse registrants. Firms that hold end-user funds also need RPAA registration with the Bank of Canada [111,109].

### CORRECTIONS TO THE DOSSIER

FINTRAC registration is free (the dossier says “<$1,000”). The RPAA registry went public in October 2025 as stated; a specific “enforcement active June 2026” date was not located. Stablecoin payment coverage under the RPAA still awaits regulations [110,111].

Sources: Bank of Canada; Norton Rose Fulbright; Osler; CryptoSlate law profiles; payments.gi; Buckingham Capital; Tycoon Story (MNP); paymentproviders.io [109,110,111].

CHAPTER 43

# Checking a provider: the public registers

Licences are claims until checked against the register that grants them. These registers are public and updated regularly.

| CLAIM TO VERIFY | WHERE TO CHECK | WHAT TO CONFIRM |
|---|---|---|
| **MiCA CASP authorisation** | ESMA interim MiCA register (weekly CSV files) | Legal entity, home NCA, authorised services (a–j), passported states; absence from the non-compliant list |
| **MiCA EMT / white paper** | ESMA register (ART/EMT issuers, white papers) | Which entity issues the token in the EU |
| **EU payment or e-money licence** | EBA Payment Institutions Register; national NCA registers | PI vs EMI status; agents and passports; whether services are provided via a third party |
| **UK payment / e-money licence** | FCA Financial Services Register | Permissions; safeguarding firm under PS25/12 |
| **Canadian MSB** | FINTRAC MSB registry (monthly) | Registered vs ceased, expired or revoked; VC dealing listed |
| **Canadian PSP** | Bank of Canada RPAA registry and applicant list | Registered, applicant, refused or revoked |
| **US stablecoin issuer / custody** | OCC charters; NYDFS; state money-transmitter licences (NMLS) | Charter type; conditional vs final approval |
| **Reserve / safeguarding** | Issuer transparency pages; attestation reports | Attesting firm, frequency, reserve composition (see page 54) |

### Virtual accounts

Ask whether vIBANs are named or pooled, which bank holds the master and safeguarding accounts, and whether the responding PSP returns VoP matches in the client's name.

### Liquidity

Ask whether conversions run on internal inventory or external market makers, and how quotes and spreads are disclosed (see pages 55–56).

**WHY IT MATTERS**

After 1 July 2026 an EU crypto counterparty without MiCA authorisation is operating unlawfully, and FINTRAC revoked 164 MSB registrations in 2026 to September. Register checks are the cheapest risk control available [103,111].

CHAPTER 44

# A euro-to-stablecoin payment, and checking the dossier

## Illustrative €20,000 pay-in converted to USDC

MODEL · timings and fees are assumptions

| STEP | RULE OR DATA POINT | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **Payer bank runs VoP on the vIBAN** | Response within 5 s, preferably 1 s [100] | VERIFIED |
| **SEPA Instant credit** | Funds available within 10 s [99] | VERIFIED |
| **Provider credits client sub-ledger** | Safeguarded at a credit institution (PSD2/EMD2) | VERIFIED |
| **EUR → USDC conversion** | EURC traded ~$1.16 in Sep 2026, so €20,000 ≈ $23,200 before spread (dossier used 1.0850 → $21,700) [112] | PARTIAL |
| **On-chain delivery** | Sub-second to seconds on Base, Solana or Arc; gas typically cents or less [67] | ESTIMATE |
| **Total “18 seconds, 0.18% vs SWIFT 48 h, 2.8%”** | Illustrative; no source for the blended figures | ESTIMATE |

## Dossier claim check

| CLAIM | FINDING | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **VoP mandatory in the euro area from 9 Oct 2025** | Confirmed; non-euro states 9 Jul 2027 | VERIFIED |
| **MiCA transition ended 1 Jul 2026 (Art. 143(3))** | Confirmed by ESMA | VERIFIED |
| **EBA 24 Sep 2026 call on multi-issuer stablecoins** | Confirmed; concerns third-country schemes, not named consortia | PARTIAL |
| **ESMA proposals of 30 Sep 2026** | Not located; 30 Sep was the Commission consultation deadline | UNVERIFIED |
| **No-match warnings cause >40% abandonment** | No source located | UNVERIFIED |
| **“2026 EBA guidelines” on vIBAN monitoring** | EBA's vIBAN work is the May 2024 report; no 2026 guideline found | PARTIAL |
| **FINTRAC MSB costs “<$1,000”** | Registration is free | UNVERIFIED |
| **RPAA registry live Oct 2025** | Confirmed | VERIFIED |
| **PI cannot hold stored value; EMI can** | Correct under PSD2/EMD2; regimes merge under PSD3 | VERIFIED |

The dossier's FurlPay integration checklist is product-specific and outside this global report; its register list is reflected on page 73.

PART VI

# Digital banks & IBAN issuers




76 League table: verified figures

77 Revolut

78 UK digital banks compared

79 Wise

80 N26, bunq, Klarna

81 PayPal, Stripe, Banking Circle

82 Local, passported & virtual IBANs

83 Dossier check


**$2.3B**

Revolut's 2025 profit before tax, a 38% margin on $6.0B revenue [114]

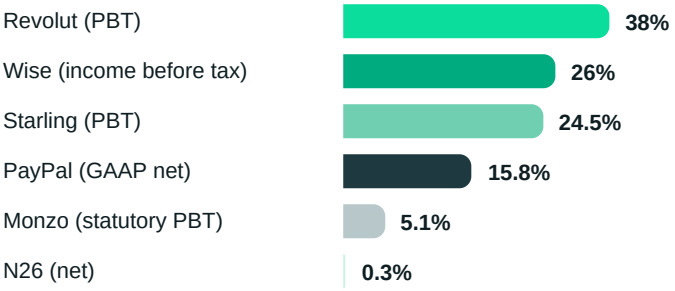
DIGITAL BANKS · CHAPTER 45

# Who issues IBANs at scale: the verified league table

Figures are taken from each company's latest annual report, results release or SEC filing. Periods differ, so rows are not directly additive; “n/d” means no current public figure was located. No company publishes how many IBANs it has issued, so this is not a ranking by IBAN count.

| COMPANY | CHARTER / LISTING | CUSTOMERS | REVENUE | PROFIT | PERIOD | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Revolut** | UK bank (PRA, Mar 2026); EU bank via Revolut Bank UAB (Lithuania) | 68.3M retail + 767k business (Dec 2025); 75M+ retail (Jul 2026) | $6.0B (£4.5B) | PBT $2.3B (38%) | FY Dec 2025 | VERIFIED |
| **PayPal (group)** | US-listed; PayPal Europe is a Luxembourg bank (background) | 439M active accounts | $33.2B | GAAP net income $5.2B | FY Dec 2025 | VERIFIED |
| **Klarna Group** | NYSE: KLAR; Klarna Bank AB is a Swedish bank | 120M active consumers | $1.042B (quarter) | Adj. op. income $91M; net $9M | Q2 2026 | VERIFIED |
| **Wise Group** | Nasdaq: WSE (primary) & LSE; EMI/PI licences | 18.9M active customers | ~$2.5B (implied) | Income before tax $660.4M (26%) | FY Mar 2026 | VERIFIED |
| **Monzo** | UK bank (PRA/FCA) | 15.2M customers | £1.71B | Adj. PBT £172.6M; statutory £87.3M | FY Mar 2026 | VERIFIED |
| **Starling** | UK bank (PRA/FCA) | 6.2M accounts | £887.4M | PBT £217.1M | FY Mar 2026 | VERIFIED |
| **N26** | German bank (BaFin/ECB) | 5.6M revenue-relevant | €501.6M | Net income €1.6M | FY Dec 2025 | VERIFIED |
| **bunq** | Dutch bank (DNB) | 20M users (May 2026) | n/d for 2025 | Net profit €85.3M (2024) | FY Dec 2024 | PARTIAL |
| **Stripe** | Private; not a bank; accounts via partner banks | n/d | TPV $1.9T (2025) | n/d | 2025 | PARTIAL |
| **Banking Circle** | Luxembourg bank (CSSF); B2B only | 200+ FIs (2021) | €267B run-rate volume (2021) | n/d | 2021 | OUTDATED |

## Profit margin, latest full year




**READING THE TABLE**

Profit definitions differ: Revolut and Starling report profit before tax; Monzo's headline £172.6M is adjusted (statutory £87.3M); Klarna's adjusted operating income excludes share-based pay; PayPal and N26 are net income. Wise's revenue is implied from its reported 26% margin on $660.4M [114–122].

Sources: Company reports and filings [114–123].

REVOLUT · CHAPTER 46

# Revolut: the most profitable private fintech

**REVENUE 2025**
**$6.0B**
£4.5B, +46% [114]

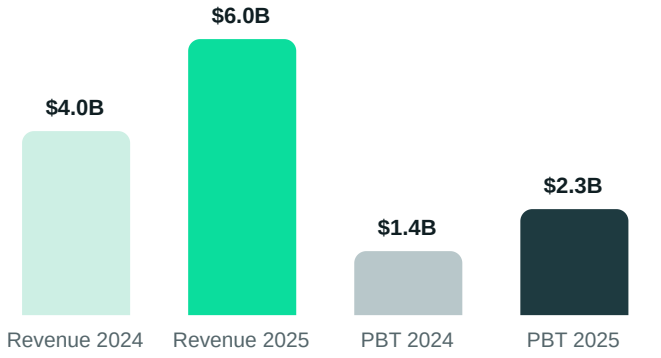
**PROFIT BEFORE TAX**
**$2.3B**
£1.7B, +57%; margin 38% [114]

**CUSTOMER BALANCES**
**$67.5B**
+66% (£50.2B) [114]

**VALUATION**
**$115B**
Secondary sale, Jul 2026 [115]

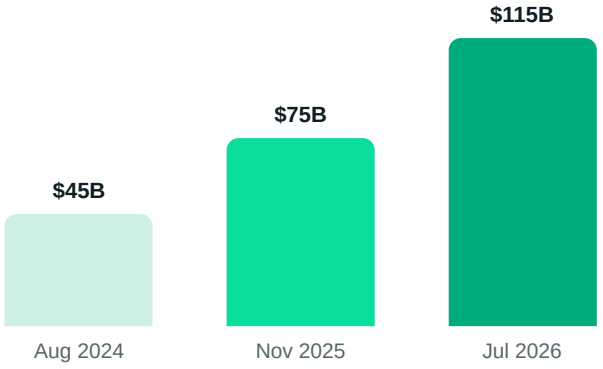
## Revenue and PBT

USD billions




## Secondary-sale valuation

USD billions




| METRIC (2025) | VALUE |
|---|---|
| **Retail customers** | 68.3M (from 52.5M); 75M+ by Jul 2026; target 100M by mid-2027 [114,115] |
| **Business customers** | 767,000 (+33%); Revolut Business 16% of revenue, revenue +53%; $365B business volume [114] |
| **Loans** | £2.2B, +120% [114] |
| **Transaction volume** | $1.7T [114] |
| **Product lines >£100M revenue** | 11 [114] |
| **Net profit** | $1.7B; fifth consecutive profitable year [114] |
| **Licences** | Full UK banking licence (Mar 2026); EU bank (Revolut Bank UAB); Mexico banking licence; US OCC/FDIC application (Mar 2026) [114,115] |
| **Secondary sale (Jul 2026)** | $2,017 per share; at least $750M of stock; no new capital raised; IPO not before 2028 [115] |

**LOCAL IBANS**

Revolut originally gave EU customers Lithuanian (LT) IBANs. Through branches of Revolut Bank UAB it has added local IBANs, starting with Ireland (retail from March 2023; corporate from May 2023) and France, to counter IBAN discrimination [124]. Revolut's report does not publish deposit or salary-account effects by country.

Sources: Revolut Annual Report 2025 and release (24 Mar 2026); CNBC; CoinDesk; Euronews; Tech.eu; Sifted; TechCrunch [114,115,124].

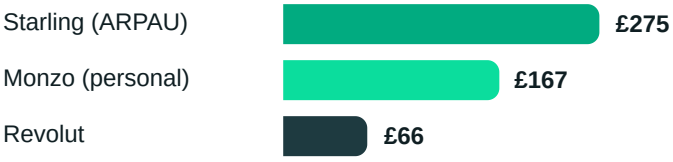
UK · CHAPTER 47

# UK digital banks: three models, three margins

| FY TO MAR 2026 (REVOLUT: DEC 2025) | REVOLUT | MONZO | STARLING |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Revenue** | £4.5B (+46%) | £1.71B (+39%) | £887.4M (−6%) |
| **Profit before tax** | £1.7B | £172.6M adjusted; £87.3M statutory | £217.1M (FY25 £223.4M) |
| **Customers / accounts** | 68.3M retail | 15.2M; 10.4M monthly active | 6.2M accounts (from 5.3M) |
| **Deposits / balances** | £50.2B balances | £25.7B (+55%) | Avg £4,241 per customer |
| **Lending** | £2.2B (+120%) | £2.6B (+42%) | Mortgages incl. Fleet |
| **Primary-bank share** | n/d | 50% of active customers | 56% of SMEs; 32.5% of retail |
| **Distinctive feature** | 11 product lines >£100M | 4 revenue streams >£300M; 1.6M paid subscribers | Engine SaaS: £10.9M revenue, £70M committed ARR |
| **Other** | UK licence Mar 2026 | £59.6M APP-fraud reimbursements; Spain launch planned | ROCE 34.6%; ~130 job cuts announced Jul 2026 |

## Revenue per active customer

secondary analysis




**WHY MARGINS DIFFER**

Starling earns like a traditional bank on a smaller base; Monzo spends heavily on growth, regulation and European expansion (statutory margin ~5%); Revolut spreads fixed costs across 40 markets and many products. Falling Bank of England rates cut Starling's interest income [117,118].

Sources: Revolut, Monzo and Starling annual reports; Payment Expert; Tech.eu; UKTN; Linas Beliūnas newsletter (secondary ratios) [114,117,118].

WISE · CHAPTER 48

# Wise: cross-border infrastructure that also issues account details

**ACTIVE CUSTOMERS**
**18.9M**
FY26, +21% [116]

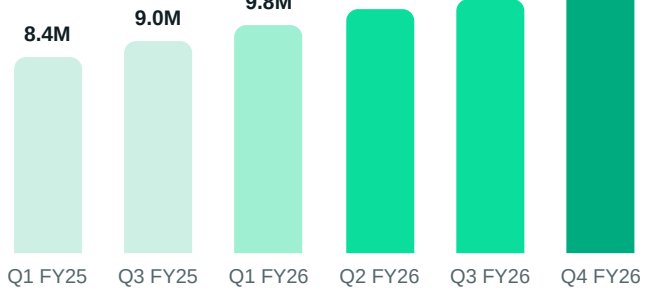
**CROSS-BORDER VOLUME**
**$243.5B**
+31% [116]

**CUSTOMER HOLDINGS**
**$39B**
Cash and assets, +40% [116]

**INCOME BEFORE TAX**
**$660.4M**
26% margin [116]

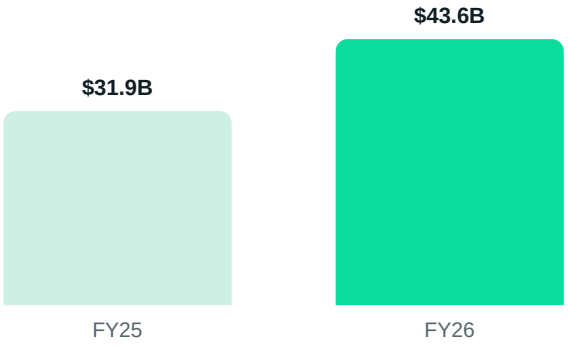
## Active customers per quarter

thousands, as reported




## Card spend

USD billions




Quarterly active customers are counted per quarter; the 18.9M annual figure counts customers active in the year [116].

| ITEM | DETAIL |
|---|---|
| **Listing** | Wise Group plc; Nasdaq (WSE) primary listing with LSE line; reports in USD under US GAAP from FY2026 [116] |
| **Interest policy** | Guides to retaining 20% of interest income above the first 1% yield; above-target 20–25% margin until it can pay out more interest [116] |
| **Account details** | Multi-currency accounts with local details in several currencies, including EUR IBANs issued via its Belgian entity (background) |
| **Customer savings** | Wise says customers saved over $3B in FY2026 versus alternatives (company claim) [116] |

**CORRECTION TO THE DOSSIER**

The dossier lists Wise revenue as £1.4B (~$1.85B). Wise now reports in US dollars; $660.4M income before tax at a 26% margin implies net revenue of roughly $2.5B. It also understates cross-border volume (>$240B, not £140B) [116].

Sources: Wise Group FY2026 results and Form 20-F (25 Jun 2026) [116].

EU · CHAPTER 49

# N26, bunq and Klarna: three EU licence strategies

## N26

BaFin

| | |
|---|---|
| 2025 | Revenue €501.6M (+13%); gross profit €350.5M (+33%); net income €1.6M vs €42M loss [119] |
| Q1 2026 | Revenue €130M; net income €9.8M (preliminary) [119] |
| SCALE | 5.6M revenue-relevant customers; €10.5B+ deposits; €170.7B volume; 24 markets [119] |
| RISK | BaFin oversight measures (Dec 2025), incl. limits in the Netherlands; founders replaced, CEO Mike Dargan from Apr 2026 [119] |

## bunq

DNB

| | |
|---|---|
| SCALE | 20M users across Europe (May 2026) [120] |
| PROFIT | €85.3M net profit in 2024 (+65%); 2025 figures not located in a primary source [120] |
| IBANS | Local NL, DE, FR, ES and IE IBANs via branches (background) |
| EXPANSION | US broker-dealer route and UK re-entry plans [120] |

## Klarna

NYSE: KLAR

| | |
|---|---|
| Q2 2026 | Revenue $1.042B (+27%); GMV $36.6B; adj. operating income $91M; net income $9M [121] |
| USERS | 120M active consumers; Klarna Card 6.5M active users in 16 countries [121] |
| GUIDE | FY2026 adj. operating income $280–300M; Q3 revenue $940–980M [121] |
| MARKET | Shares fell after volume guidance was lowered on German demand and FX [121] |

## 2025 revenue

EUR millions / USD for Klarna Q2 annualised




**CORRECTION TO THE DOSSIER**

The listed entity is Klarna Group plc (NYSE: KLAR); Klarna Bank AB is its Swedish bank. N26's 2025 revenue was €501.6M (not “over €505M”). bunq's €88M/€215M 2025 figures could not be traced to a primary source [119–121].

Sources: N26 results (25 Jun 2026); Sifted; CNBC; Finance Magnates; Euromoney; Klarna Q2 2026 release (18 Aug 2026) [119,120,121].

INFRA · CHAPTER 50

# PayPal, Stripe and Banking Circle: IBANs as infrastructure

**PAYPAL NET REVENUE**
**$33.2B**
FY2025, +4% [122]

**PAYPAL GAAP NET INCOME**
**$5.2B**
FY2025, +26% [122]

**PAYPAL ACTIVE ACCOUNTS**
**439M**
+1.1% [122]

**STRIPE TPV**
**$1.9T**
2025, +34% [16]

| COMPANY | MODEL | WHAT IS DOCUMENTED |
|---|---|---|
| **PayPal** | PayPal (Europe) S.à r.l. et Cie, S.C.A. holds a Luxembourg banking licence (background) | FY2025 GAAP operating income $6.1B; Venmo revenue $1.7B (+20%); PYUSD issued by Paxos; CEO change announced Feb 2026 [122,81] |
| **Stripe** | Not a bank; financial accounts and account details via partner banks | $1.9T TPV in 2025; Bridge, Tempo and Open Issuance; OUSD now its default business stablecoin [16,63] |
| **Banking Circle S.A.** | Luxembourg bank serving payment companies and banks; no retail clients | 2021: 200+ financial institutions, 13M+ virtual IBANs issued, €267B run-rate volume, 15 clearing schemes; TIPS instant access [123] |
| **Starling Engine** | Core-banking software sold to other banks | Clients Salt Bank (Romania), AMP Bank (Australia), Tangerine (Canada), SBS Bank (New Zealand) [118] |

**DATA GAP**

Banking Circle's recent volumes and client counts (the dossier cites €1.5T and 850+ institutions) were not located in a published source; its latest public results located are for 2021 and 2024 accounts. Stripe does not publish revenue or the number of IBANs it provides [123].

**CORRECTION TO THE DOSSIER**

PayPal's FY2025 figures are $33.2B revenue, $5.2B GAAP net income and 439M active accounts; the dossier's $31.8B and $4.5B match 2024-era results. The “110M+ EEA users” figure was not located [122].

Sources: PayPal 4Q/FY2025 release and Form ARS (SEC); Stripe letter via CoinDesk; Banking Circle annual accounts and 2021 release; Starling [122,16,123,118].

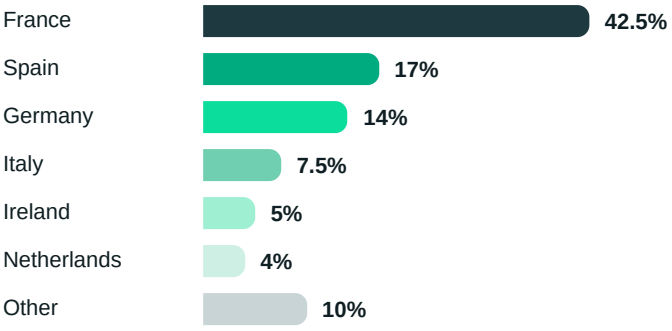
IBAN · CHAPTER 51

# Local, passported and virtual IBANs

An IBAN's country code shows where the account is held, not whether it can be used: under Article 9 of the SEPA Regulation (EU) No 260/2012, payers and payees may not refuse euro accounts held elsewhere in the EU [124].

## Reported IBAN-discrimination cases by country

End IBAN Discrimination platform




Secondary report; French authorities (DGCCRF) said they would sanction offenders [124].

## Why firms issue local IBANs

- Employers, utilities and tax portals that still refuse foreign IBANs despite Article 9
- Domestic direct-debit mandates and salary deposits
- Local branch registration for customer trust and VoP name records

| | BANK IBAN (DIRECT) | E-MONEY / PAYMENT INSTITUTION IBAN | VIRTUAL IBAN |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Who holds the account** | Customer, at a credit institution | Customer, at an EMI/PI | Master account held by a bank or PSP |
| **Deposit insurance** | Yes, up to €100k (EU DGS) / £120k (UK FSCS) | No; funds safeguarded | Depends on master-account structure; often none for end user |
| **Scheme access** | Usually direct or via correspondent | Direct for some (e.g. TIPS/TARGET access from Oct 2025) or via sponsor bank | Via the issuing bank or PSP |
| **VoP response** | Customer's name | Customer's name | End client's name if named; provider's name if pooled |
| **Interest on balances** | Bank earns NII, may pay interest | Safeguarded funds earn yield for the firm | Shared by issuing bank and provider by contract |

**INTEREST-RATE EXPOSURE**

IBAN balances make digital banks rate-sensitive: net interest is about 20% of Revolut's revenue, falling rates cut Starling's revenue 6%, and Wise caps the interest it retains. The same dynamic drives stablecoin issuers (page 53) [114,118,116].

Sources: Regulation (EU) 260/2012; End IBAN Discrimination platform via Anyti.me; Revolut; ECB; insights4vc [124,114,99].

VERIFICATION

# Checking the IBAN industry dossier

Each headline claim was traced to the company's own report, release or filing.

| DOSSIER CLAIM | FINDING | STATUS |
|---|---|---|
| **Revolut 2025: $6.0B revenue, $2.3B PBT, 38% margin** | Confirmed (annual report, 24 Mar 2026) | VERIFIED |
| **Revolut 80M+ customers mid-2026** | Company cited 75M+ retail customers in Jul 2026 | PARTIAL |
| **Revolut $115B valuation** | Confirmed secondary sale, Jul 2026 | VERIFIED |
| **Revolut revenue split (cards £1.0B, subscriptions £708M, etc.)** | Line items not located; net interest ~20% of revenue per analysis | UNVERIFIED |
| **Revolut local IBANs made it primary bank for 35M Europeans; deposits £24B+** | Not located; balances were £50.2B in total | UNVERIFIED |
| **Local IBANs lift primary-account status 65–120%** | No source located | UNVERIFIED |
| **PayPal: $31.8B revenue, $4.5B net income, 400M+ accounts** | FY2025: $33.2B, $5.2B, 439M | OUTDATED |
| **Klarna Q2 2026: $1.042B revenue, $91M adj. op. income, 120M users** | Confirmed; listed entity is Klarna Group plc | VERIFIED |
| **Wise: 18.9M customers, $660.4M income before tax** | Confirmed; revenue ~$2.5B, not $1.85B | PARTIAL |
| **Monzo: £1.7B revenue, £172.6M PBT, 15.2M customers** | Confirmed; £172.6M is adjusted (statutory £87.3M) | PARTIAL |
| **Starling: £887.4M revenue, £217.1M PBT, 6.2M accounts** | Confirmed; revenue and profit fell year on year | VERIFIED |
| **N26: first net profit €1.6M on €505M+ revenue** | Profit confirmed; revenue €501.6M | PARTIAL |
| **bunq: 20M+ users, €88M net income, €215M revenue** | 20M users confirmed; 2025 financials not located | PARTIAL |
| **Stripe: $16B revenue, $1.5B EBITDA, 3M businesses** | Not disclosed; TPV $1.9T confirmed | UNVERIFIED |
| **Banking Circle: €1.5T volume, 850+ institutions** | Not located; 2021: €267B, 200+ FIs | UNVERIFIED |

The dossier's FurlPay strategy section is product-specific and outside this global report.

SOURCES · I

# Bibliography: market, countries and networks

Numbers correspond to bracketed references throughout. Accessed September–October 2026. Labels follow the evidence grading on page 03.

1 Circle Q2 2026 results, 5 Aug 2026 · 2 Circle Q2 earnings call · 3 Circle weekly data via PANews/KuCoin · 4 Circle USDC page · 5 Reap, Stablecoin Statistics 2026 (DeFiLlama) · 6 Federal Reserve FEDS Note, 8 Apr 2026

7 CoinDesk Research, Asia Pacific, 15 Sep 2026 (Ripple-commissioned) · 8 McKinsey, Stablecoins in payments, Feb 2026 · 9 Spark (Visa/Allium) · 10 Visa US settlement, 16 Dec 2025 · 11 Visa IR, 29 Apr 2026 · 12 Stablecoin Insider, Visa $20B

13 Visa FQ3 2026 · 14 Mastercard stablecoin settlement, Jun 2026 · 15 The Block, BVNK close · 16 CoinDesk, Stripe annual letter · 17 Everstake, Tempo · 18 OCC Bulletin 2026-3 · 19 US Treasury GENIUS proposal, 17 Aug 2026

20 PYMNTS, OCC timeline · 21 Bank of England, 22 Jun 2026 · 22 Payment Expert, FCA PS26/10 · 23 Payment Expert, RBI (Reuters) · 24 Xflow · 25 The Crypto Times, India policy · 26 The Crypto Times, USDT premium

27 InvestNews, Receita Federal data · 28 CryptoSlate, Res. 561 · 29 Plasma, Brazil map · 30 Mobile Time/LetsMoney, Pix · 31 Finsiders Brasil · 32 a16z crypto, card spend, Aug 2026 · 33 CoinDesk, card spend $1B

34 CoinDesk, Rain · 35 The Defiant via KuCoin, Coinbase x402 · 36 Forkast, x402 Foundation · 37 Mariblock, Chainalysis SSA · 38 The Block, UAE · 39 Arc blog · 40 Forbes, a16z Q1 · 41 Forbes, $33T volume

42 Transak · 47 The Block, Mastercard options · 48 Spark, Stripe–Bridge · 51 Bitcoin Foundation News, chains · 52 The Cryptonomist, India · 53 Tazapay (EY-Parthenon) · 54 PANews/TokenPost, USDC week to 21 Sep

56 RWA Foundation via U.Today, 2 Oct 2026 · 57 Stablecoinbeat, 10 Sep 2026 · 58 Messari State of TRON Q2 2026 · 59 Treasury GENIUS interim final rule via Yahoo Finance · 60 Fed R-1899/R-1900 via fintechlaw.ai

61 Sullivan & Cromwell, OCC NPRM memo; Troutman Pepper · 62 CoinDesk; Crumpton Global; Forexcrunch; BlockEden: Res. 561 · 63 Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Blockhead, Benzinga: OUSD · 64 PYMNTS, OUSD & SoFiUSD

65 Chainalysis, 2026 Global Crypto Adoption Index, 23 Sep 2026 · 66 Tether Q2 2026 attestation via Cointelegraph, crypto.news, Stablecoin Insider, Bitcoin.com · 67 Circle, Decrypt, Cryptopolitan, CoinReporter: Arc

68 CNBC, CoinDesk, AMINA: CLARITY vote · 69 CryptoDaily/Economic Times: RBI · 70 CoinGecko, CryptoNexa, Coinpedia, Seoul Economic Daily: Korea · 71 PYMNTS, Circle Q4 2025 · 72 web3wagmi (secondary) · 73 Blockhead

74 24/7 Wall St, Visa · 75 TRM Labs, Q1 2026 Adoption Index · 76 BitDegree / Moneycontrol: India Economic Survey

SOURCES · II

# Bibliography: Part IV — market structure, liquidity and risk

77 Cointelegraph and BigGo: Mantle joins GDN; USDG $3.18B, 150+ partners, 3 Sep 2026 · CoinStats USDG analysis, Aug 2026 · 78 Global Dollar Network press release, 4 Dec 2025 (PR Newswire)

79 Paxos newsroom, Winding Down USDL Lift Dollar, Oct 2025; Blockchain.News · 80 Paxos transparency pages: PYUSD, USDP, USDG, BUSD (accessed Oct 2026)

81 PYUSD: CoinMarketCap AI (19 Aug 2026), Pluang (6 Jun 2026), Coin360 (17 Mar 2026), The Block price page, Stablecoin Insider Q2 2026 report

82 OCC conditional national trust charters, 12 Dec 2025, via Steptoe, Axios, The Block, Ledger Insights

83 Circle Internet Group Form 10-Q for quarters ended 31 Mar and 30 Jun 2026 (SEC EDGAR); Q2 2026 release; insights4vc and Beancount analyses (Sep 2026)

84 BlackRock Funds Form N-CSR, Circle Reserve Fund, FYE 30 Apr 2026; Deloitte & Touche opinion 23 Jun 2026 (SEC EDGAR) · 85 Coinbase Q2 2026 earnings deck (Form 8-K) and 10-Q; The Defiant; Pulse 2.0; Tiger Brokers

86 Wintermute, Digital asset OTC flow: The institutional effect, 30 Jul 2026, via Cointelegraph, crypto.news, BigGo · 87 Dwellir, State of DeFi Q3 2026 (DefiLlama data, 26 Sep 2026)

88 Congressional Research Service, The Stablecoin Yield Debate, IF13174, 6 Mar 2026 · 89 Cozen O'Connor (Nov 2025); Cointelegraph (ABA); BlockEden (Jan 2026); tech-insider (OCC NPRM summary)

90 rwa.xyz via Investax Q1 2026 report, asset.haus (Jun 2026), KuCoin/Streamlinefeed (Jul 2026); GitHub market analysis (Sep 2026) · 91 Ethena: Stablecoin Insider Q1 2026; CoinStats (Sep 2026); CoinMarketCap AI

92 Circle CCTP blog (Nov 2025); GNcrypto and Bitcoin.com (USDC Bridge, Apr 2026); Crossmint (Stellar, Jun 2026); range.org explorer · 93 Across blog (Mar 2026); Solana Compass

94 Solana Foundation, Privacy docs; The Block (Confidential Balances, Apr 2025); Chainstack (Mar 2026); MEXC Arc launch guide (Sep 2026) · 95 Spark depeg history; Simianx; Cointelegraph/Kaiko (Mar 2023); Kraken Learn; KoinX

96 Spark, Stablecoin depeg risk calculator (attestors; Circle Mint fees, Mar 2026) · 97 S&P Global Ratings, USDC Stablecoin Stability Assessment · 98 World Bank, SDG 10.c.1 metadata; Remittance Prices Worldwide

SOURCES · III

# Bibliography: Part V — fiat rails and licences

99 Regulation (EU) 2024/886 (Instant Payments Regulation); ECB IPR page; McCann FitzGerald; Matheson; MHC; Deutsche Bank corporate note

100 European Payments Council, VoP Scheme Rulebook and public consultation on urgent change requests (Dec 2025); LUXHUB VOP User Group 7 (Feb 2026); Bottomline VoP explainer

101 UniCredit, Verification-of-Payee webinar, 28–29 May 2026; ABE / EBA Clearing, Key challenges for VOP matching checks (Sep 2025); KPMG Germany

102 EBA, Report on virtual IBANs, 24 May 2024, and press release; FIAU Malta; PwC Legal; A&O Shearman; Azienda Banca on Banca d'Italia UIF analysis

103 ESMA, Statement on the end of transitional periods under MiCA (17 Apr 2026) and Public Statement on orderly wind-down (Jun 2026)

104 ESMA interim MiCA register via Elliptic, MiCA Crypto Alliance (23 Jul 2026), Forklog, CV5 Capital, Coinpaprika, penning.io tracker

105 EBA No-Action Letter on PSD2/MiCA interplay (10 Jun 2025) and Opinion on end of transition (12 Feb 2026); Plesner; DLA Piper; CMS; Hogan Lovells; McCann FitzGerald

106 EBA response to the Commission MiCA review consultation (24 Sep 2026); European Commission targeted consultation (20 May 2026); Skadden; Notabene; Regulation Tomorrow; Crowdfund Insider

107 PSD3/PSR: Council provisional agreement via Taylor Wessing (27 Nov 2025); MoFo (Apr 2026); Worldline (Mar 2026); PwC; Bratby Law

108 FCA Policy Statement PS25/12 safeguarding regime, in force 7 May 2026, via Bratby Law and Regulation Tomorrow

109 Bank of Canada retail payments supervision pages and FAQ (Aug 2026); Norton Rose Fulbright; Osler

110 CryptoSlate law profiles: RPAA, RPAR, FINTRAC virtual-currency regime; payments.gi Canada monitor (Stablecoin Act)

111 FINTRAC MSB registration guidance via Buckingham Capital Consulting, Tycoon Story (MNP analysis), Salvus; paymentproviders.io (Sep 2026)

112 Euro stablecoins: Token Terminal via CoinTurk (9 Sep 2026); Decta Euro Stablecoin Trends Report (Jul 2026); CryptoBriefing; AMBCrypto / CoinGecko EURC data

113 Tazapay, MiCA CASP authorization (Aug 2026)

SOURCES · IV

# Bibliography: Part VI and back cover

114 Revolut Group Holdings, Annual Report 2025 and release (24 Mar 2026); CNBC; CoinDesk; Euronews; Global Banking & Finance Review; insights4vc

115 Revolut secondary sale: Tech.eu, Sifted, Crowdfund Insider, Seedtable (22–23 Jul 2026); TechCrunch (21 Apr 2026); Crunchbase News (Nov 2025)

116 Wise Group plc, Full Year 2026 Financial Results and Form 20-F (25 Jun 2026)

117 Monzo Annual Report and Accounts 2026; Payment Expert, Tech.eu, UKTN (19 May 2026); Linas Beliūnas newsletter (26 May 2026)

118 Starling Group FY2026 results (21 May 2026); Tech.eu; Starling FY2025 results; Linas Beliūnas newsletter (27 May 2026)

119 N26 FY2025 results (25 Jun 2026); Sifted; Crowdfund Insider; Tab Insights

120 bunq: CNBC on 2024 results; Finance Magnates (May 2026); Euromoney (2026); City A.M.

121 Klarna Group plc, Q2 2026 results and earnings release (18 Aug 2026); Quartr; Beancount analysis

122 PayPal Holdings, 4Q and FY2025 results (Feb 2026) and Form ARS (SEC); Electronic Payments International

123 Banking Circle S.A., Annual Accounts 31 Dec 2024; Banking Circle 2021 results release via Crowdfund Insider

124 Regulation (EU) No 260/2012, Art. 9; End IBAN Discrimination platform / DGCCRF via Anyti.me; Revolut blog; Revolut Ireland local IBAN release (30 May 2023)




FurlPay

**Move money globally with digital dollars.**

For information only; not investment, legal or tax advice. Company figures are as reported in the cited filings and releases; periods and profit definitions differ. Verify licences on the official registers listed on page 73.